COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

The Fed & Macro Regime Pillar Report

Liquidity as the Master Driver — Researched, Scored, and Re-Rated

Originally written and scores committed by me on June 12, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (re-rated up to a moderated 40/38/47/55/62 on the BLS July jobs report, committed and stamped by Alex). Re-rated up again August 13 to 43/41/48/56/62 on a cool CPI print and a weak claims print; held flat August 14, 16, and through two Aug 22 cycles (a catch-up draft, then the full weekly refresh) — committed and stamped by Alex August 23, 2026, the last true baseline. A same-day catch-up draft written August 28 (score set `2026-08-28_draft`) re-rated down to 38/37/46/55/61 on Fed Chair Warsh's hawkish Jackson Hole speech and a hot July PCE print, but was ***never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed*** *— it sits abandoned, superseded mid-cycle.* ***This version (August 29, score set `2026-08-29_draft`) is a FULL WEEKLY refresh and goes further, re-rating down to 36/35/45/55/61.*** *A dedicated adversarial-verification pass this cycle caught a real error in the abandoned draft: its CME FedWatch September rate-hike-odds figure (~35.4%→~45.7%) UNDERSTATED the actual market move. Independent re-pull and cross-check — Motley Fool citing CME FedWatch directly at 57.5%, CNBC's own body text at "nearly 56%," and a third independent source at "55.7%" — shows the real post-speech reading clustered tightly in the high-50s, roughly 56-58%, not 45.7%: September hike odds are now past coin-flip, not just approaching it. Two fresh facts not in the abandoned draft: initial jobless claims for the week ended Aug 22 (DOL, primary, Aug 27) came in at 203,000 vs. 208,000 consensus, a mild hawkish-adjacent tightening signal; and the Aug 26 H.4.1 balance-sheet release (federalreserve.gov, primary) showed the same reserve-drain pattern continuing (reserve balances −$10,351M w/w to $2,924,936M; TGA −$2,876M w/w to $950,736M), logged but not independently trigger-worthy. This cycle also corrects the abandoned draft's price-action framing: BTC did NOT hold a stable tape through the speech — it opened Aug 28 around $80,262, traded above $81,000 pre-speech, then fell back sharply once Warsh spoke, closing $79,613.44 that day, and continued falling to $77,666.16 by today, Aug 29 (Bitstamp) — a real, visible reaction, not a shrug.* ***Net: the corrected, larger CME move justifies a deeper cut than the abandoned draft reached.*** *1mo 43→36 (-7), 3mo 41→35 (-6), 6mo 48→45 (-3), 1yr 56→55 (-1), 3yr 62→61 (-1) — still minimal at the long end, since Warsh explicitly declined to commit to a reaction function and one repricing doesn't reach three years out. Left as draft at delivery, not auto-stamped: this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, which the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority categorically excludes regardless of move size — doubly so here since every window moved 7 points or fewer anyway. Flagged for Alex's manual review; see My Decision below.* ***THIS VERSION (August 31) is a light daily catch-up, score set 2026-08-31_draft****, covering Aug 29-31: CME FedWatch September hike odds continued drifting up post-Warsh (CNBC Aug 28: ~45.7%; CoinSpectator/Bitcoin.com Aug 30: ~57%; CNBC Aug 31 Jackson-Hole-roundup: ~60.4%, up from ~56% Friday) — directionally the same hawkish repricing already sized into the Aug 29 cut (which used a 56-58% cluster as its basis). Per the sufficiency rule, a market-odds drift alone, without a fresh primary data print or news event, cannot move P further. No new H.4.1 (next due Sept 3, last Aug 27) or jobless claims release landed in this window.* ***P HELD FLAT at 36/35/45/55/61.*** *This is a light daily touch, no window moved, no call band flipped —* ***AUTO-STAMPED*** *per delegated daily authority.* ***Sept 1: held flat again*** *— CME FedWatch September hike odds continued the same post-Jackson-Hole drift (Forbes/KuCoin ~66% at 11:40am ET Aug 31, up from the ~60.4% CNBC read this pillar's Aug 31 baseline used), but it's the same intraday drift sequence with no new primary print or news event behind it, so per the sufficiency rule it does not independently move P; no new H.4.1 or claims release landed (Aug 31 was Labor Day). Score set 2026-09-01_draft, AUTO-STAMPED, new last COMMITTED baseline.* ***Sept 2: held flat a further time*** *— no new H.4.1 or data print found dated Sept 1-2; September 15-16 FOMC market pricing (CME FedWatch roughly*

60% hold) continues the same post-Jackson-Hole drift already priced into the Sept 1 baseline, not a fresh data-driven move, so per the sufficiency rule it does not independently move P. Score set 2026-09-02_draft — this pillar's own P is unaffected, but because all four qualitative pillars share one dated score set and Iran War Risk's sharp re-rate this cycle flips the master call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) and needs Alex's manual review, the WHOLE 2026-09-02_draft set — Fed & Macro's flat P included — stays in DRAFT status, not committed, per house rule (see My Decision and the Iran War Risk pillar report); COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 once Alex widened the policy — this is the last TRUE committed baseline: 36/35/45/55/61. ***Sept 3: held flat a further time*** *— light daily catch-up found nothing material on any of the four qualitative pillars; config/scores.json untouched, blend re-run against fresh quant data only.* ***Sept 5, light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-05_draft): RE-RATED DOWN a modest further step, 36/35/45/55/61 → 32/31/43/54/60.*** *The August jobs report (BLS, primary, released Sept 4) beat sharply — nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus, unemployment steady at 4.1% — and markets repriced September 15-16 FOMC hike odds higher off of it (CNBC, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, U.S. News, Investing.com/Reuters — point estimates vary 60-66% by source/timestamp but are directionally consistent and higher than the Sept 2 baseline's "~60% hold" framing). Same-day reaction: 2yr Treasury yield +5.3bp to its highest since January 2025; Dow −0.51%, S&P −0.38%, Nasdaq −0.29%; BTC fell ~2% same-day ($81,265.00 Sept 3 close → $79,676.60 Sept 4 close). Fed officials remain split (Warsh hawkish; Waller says he'd lean toward holding if inflation improves), with the Sept 11 CPI print now flagged as the likely decider before Sept 15-16. Move sized comparably to the Aug 22→28 catch-up cut on the Warsh Jackson Hole speech alone (a comparable single dated catalyst): 1mo −4, 3mo −4, 6mo −2, 1yr −1, 3yr −1, no window over 8 points.* ***CORRECTION:*** *that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 5, 2026," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here and not corrected retroactively (stamping is Alex's call).* ***Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version:*** *independently re-verified via WebSearch — Fed Governor Waller's genuinely dovish-leaning Sept 3 speech ("give disinflation a chance") briefly cut CME hike odds to ~48% (Semafor, CNBC, Bloomberg, PBS) before the Sept 4 jobs beat reversed that back up to 60-66% (Forbes/CME FedWatch), a net hawkish drift for the week consistent with the Sept 5 cut. No further Fed commentary or data since; the Sept 11 CPI print has not yet landed.* ***HELD FLAT at this cycle's re-rated level, 32/31/43/54/60. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of move size — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX SEPTEMBER 5, 2026. Sept 6: light daily catch-up, held flat.*** *Re-checked via WebSearch: no new Fed speech, data release, or FOMC commentary since Sept 3-4 (Governor Waller's dovish-leaning Sept 3 speech and the Sept 4 BLS August payrolls beat were already captured in the Sept 5 re-rate). September 6 is a Saturday — markets and the Fed's own calendar are quiet, no data or speeches scheduled. The September 11 CPI print remains the next dated catalyst and has not yet landed.* ***HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60. Sept 8: light daily catch-up, held flat again.*** *Re-checked via WebSearch: no new Fed speech, data release, or FOMC commentary since Sept 3-4; the Sept 11 CPI print and the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remain the next dated catalysts, not pre-empted this cycle.* ***HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60. Sept 9: light daily catch-up, held flat again.*** *Re-checked directly against CME FedWatch-citing coverage — September 25bp-hike odds read ~58.7% (as of Sept 7, CNBC/cryptonews), consistent with the ~56-58% cluster already priced into the baseline, not a fresh move; no new FOMC meeting, no new BLS/DOL primary release since Sept 3-4. The Sept 11 CPI print and Sept 15-16 FOMC remain the next dated catalysts.* ***HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60. Sept 10: light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft) vs the 2026-09-09_draft committed baseline.*** *Held flat at 32/31/43/54/60 — independently re-checked, nothing cleared the sufficiency bar. The Aug CPI release (due Sept 11) and the FOMC meeting (Sept 15-16) are both still pending per BLS/Fed calendars — no new primary data since Sept 9. The master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip anywhere (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull → Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority this set is* ***AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)." THIS VERSION (September 11, score set 2026-09-11_draft) RE-RATES UP, modestly, to 34/33/44/54/60.*** *This cycle deliberately held its research window open past 8:30am ET for the print this pillar has been flagging for a week, and the August CPI print landed on schedule at 8:30am ET: BLS's own release (bls.gov, primary, fetched directly and re-fetched to confirm) has headline CPI-U* ***+0.4% m/m SA*** *in August after +0.1% in July and* ***+3.4% y/y NSA****, with core (all items less food and energy)* ***+0.3% m/m*** *after +0.2% in July and* ***+2.4% y/y****; energy rose 2.1% m/m and gasoline 3.9%, accounting for over a third of the monthly increase, while shelter rose 0.3%. Against the consensus circulating pre-print (headline +0.4% m/m / 3.4% y/y; core +0.4% m/m / 2.4% y/y), headline landed exactly in line and* ***core came in one tenth cooler on the month****, core y/y in line — a modest dovish surprise* ***[CORRECTED in the Sept 12 second cycle (2026-09-12_draft2): the real pre-print core consensus was +0.2%***

m/m, so the +0.3% print was a tenth HOTTER, not cooler — this up-move has been reversed. See This Cycle above.] *in the window that brackets the Sept 15-16 FOMC. It is tempered, not clean relief: headline accelerated from +0.1% to +0.4% and the acceleration is energy-driven — the same oil shock that fires the Iran pillar's "sustained Brent >$100" clause this cycle shows up here as headline inflation. Market-implied September hike odds circulating around the print (~70% for a 25bp move) are a market price, reported and not used to move P; the BLS release itself is the mover. Cross-source caution logged: several aggregator summaries of this print circulating within minutes carried figures inconsistent with the BLS release (e.g. a 3.1% core y/y) — discarded in favour of the primary document. Re-rated up on the windows bracketing the FOMC only:* ***1mo 32→34, 3mo 31→33, 6mo 43→44****; 12mo and 36mo held flat at 54/60 — a single in-line-to-a-tenth-cooler print does not move the multi-year regime read.* ***AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."***

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 20% OF MY THESIS (EQUAL, 1/5)

Written June 12, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified September 12, 2026 — SECOND cycle of the day (score set 2026-09-12_draft2): RE-RATED DOWN to 29/28/41/53/60, correcting the core-CPI consensus figure both prior sets used (the real consensus was +0.2%, so August core at +0.3% m/m was a tenth HOTTER, not cooler) and cutting further on the UMich preliminary September survey · Last TRUE committed: 34/33/44/54/60 (2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped Sept 12) · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me on June 12, 2026. Aug 22 draft2 is the last committed baseline (stamped by Alex Aug 23, 2026). Aug 28 was a same-day catch-up draft that re-rated down but was ***never delivered*** *(not rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed) — shown for lineage only, superseded. Aug 29 was a FULL WEEKLY refresh that went further, after an adversarial-verification pass corrected an understated CME odds figure in the abandoned draft — left as draft, committed by Alex. Aug 31 and Sept 1 are light daily catch-ups that each held flat and were AUTO-STAMPED. Sept 2 held flat again and was originally left as draft only because Iran War Risk's re-rate flipped the master call band; COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3 once Alex widened the policy — this is the last TRUE committed baseline at 36/35/45/55/61. Sept 3 held flat a further time (nothing material found on any pillar).* ***Sept 5, light daily catch-up (2026-09-05_draft)*** *re-rates down a further modest step on a hot August jobs report and higher FOMC hike-odds pricing to 32/31/43/54/60; that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status was never actually advanced to committed — a bug, flagged as a correction this cycle.* ***Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2, this version)*** *independently re-confirms the re-rate via fresh WebSearch research; categorically excluded from daily auto-stamp authority, so it went to manual review and is* ***COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026*** *at 32/31/43/54/60.* ***Sept 6 and Sept 8 light daily catch-ups (2026-09-06_draft, 2026-09-08_draft)*** *each independently re-checked and held flat — no new Fed speech or data release since Sept 3-4, the Sept 11 CPI print still pending — and were* ***AUTO-STAMPED****, Sept 8 the last COMMITTED baseline.* ***Sept 9 (2026-09-09_draft, this version)*** *holds flat a further time — CME September hike odds ~58.7% read consistent with the already-priced cluster, not a fresh move —* ***AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority****, the new last COMMITTED baseline.* ***Sept 10 (2026-09-10_draft)*** *holds flat a further time — the Aug CPI release (due Sept 11) and the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remain pending per BLS/Fed calendars —* ***AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority****, the last COMMITTED baseline.* ***Sept 11 (2026-09-11_draft, this version)*** *RE-RATES UP modestly to 34/33/44/54/60 once the August CPI print lands: headline in line at +0.4% m/m / 3.4% y/y, core one tenth cooler than consensus at +0.3% m/m (2.4% y/y), with the headline acceleration energy-driven* ***[CORRECTED in the Sept 12 second cycle (2026-09-12_draft2): the real pre-print core consensus was +0.2% m/m, so the +0.3% print was a tenth HOTTER, not cooler — this up-move has been reversed. See This Cycle above.]*** *—* ***AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority****, the new last COMMITTED baseline.*

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/22 D2	8/28	8/29	8/31-9/3	9/5 D2	9/6	9/8	9/9	9/10	9/11-9/12 (COMM.)	9/12 D2	QUAL.	IMP.	SIGNAL	MY CALL
1 month	38	...	43	38	36	36	32	32	32	32	32	34	**29**	0.85	8	**−2.86**	Bear — core CPI overshot consensus (the Sept 11 read corrected), UMich sentiment fell to 47.8 with year-ahead inflation expectations jumping to 4.6%, and market-implied Sept 16 hike odds reached ~90%; this window brackets the FOMC most directly
3 months	40	...	41	37	35	35	31	31	31	31	31	33	**28**	0.85	8	**−2.99**	Bear — the Sept 15-16 FOMC decision sits in this window, with a hike now near fully priced
6 months	46	...	48	46	45	45	43	43	43	43	43	44	**41**	0.80	8	**−1.15**	Mild Bear — carryover from the same catalyst, plus institutional calls adding a December hike
1 year	54	...	56	55	55	55	54	54	54	54	54	54	**53**	0.75	8	**+0.36**	Mild Bull — minimal move; a single meeting does not reset the

																year-out regime read
3 years	61	...	62	61	61	61	60	60	60	60	60	60	**60**	0.65	8	**+1.04**	Mild Bull — structural accumulate, unchanged; a hiking cycle is not a three-year story

Last TRUE committed P (2026-09-10_draft, held flat, auto-stamped Sept 10): 32 / 31 / 43 / 54 / 60 · **Current committed P (2026-09-11_draft, light daily catch-up, auto-stamped):** 34 / 33 / 44 / 54 / 60 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P − 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Full lineage: June committed 38/40/46/54/61 (Jun 12) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8-Sept 8 path) → **Sept 9 light daily catch-up (2026-09-09_draft) 32/31/43/54/60** — held flat again: CME September hike odds read ~58.7% (CNBC/cryptonews), consistent with the ~56-58% cluster already priced in, not a fresh move; no new FOMC meeting, no new BLS/DOL release since Sept 3-4 — **AUTO-STAMPED**, the committed baseline → **Sept 10 light daily catch-up (2026-09-10_draft) 32/31/43/54/60** — held flat a further time: the Aug CPI release (due Sept 11) and the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remain pending per BLS/Fed calendars, no new primary data since Sept 9 — **AUTO-STAMPED**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds the macro regime is *good for crypto* by then — not "the Fed cuts by then." Re-rated down this cycle to 36/35/45/55/61 from the committed 43/41/48/56/62 — further than the abandoned, never-delivered Aug 28 draft's 38/37/46/55/61. The underlying trigger is the same one that draft identified: Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Chair (federalreserve.gov, primary transcript, Aug 28, "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy") — confirmed verbatim this cycle via direct fetch of the transcript: "And while this summer's PCE and CPI readings were better than expected, they do not tell me that underlying trends have meaningfully improved." (The widely-used "may need to raise rates" framing is a fair journalistic paraphrase, used independently by CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Forbes, and Spectrum News — not a direct Warsh quote; flagged as paraphrase here per this pillar's own sourcing discipline.) Corroborated overall by CNBC, PBS, Reuters/investing.com, CNN, and Yahoo Finance (a Washington Post direct fetch was blocked 403 this cycle; relied on search-summary only for that one outlet). **What changed the size of this re-rate: a dedicated adversarial-verification pass this cycle caught that the abandoned Aug 28 draft's CME FedWatch figure was wrong.** That draft cited September rate-hike odds jumping from ~35.4% to ~45.7% same-day. Independent re-pull and cross-check instead shows the real post-speech reading clustered tightly in the high-50s: Motley Fool quotes CME FedWatch directly at 57.5%; CNBC's own body text says "nearly 56%" (its "coin flip" headline rounds that down, it doesn't contradict it); a third independently-sourced read puts it at "55.7%... about 20 points higher than a day ago." Those three cluster tightly and are treated as the credible read; the 45.7%/42% figures that circulated are treated as a stale or garbled snapshot and explicitly discarded. Corrected characterization: CME September hike odds moved from ~35% to roughly 56-58% — past coin-flip, into hike-more-likely-than-not territory, a materially bigger repricing than first drafted. The 2-year Treasury yield's move is confirmed at roughly +6.6bp to 4.29% intraday-close (one source cites a peak of +9bp to 4.32%), a roughly one-month high. This clears the sufficiency bar — a primary Fed source, 4+ independent corroborating outlets, and a corrected, clean quantified market-odds shift — and the deeper re-rate is concentrated on the windows that bracket the Sept 15 FOMC decision the odds move is actually about: 1mo and 3mo take the largest cuts, 6mo a smaller one, and 1yr/3yr move only marginally since one speech and one odds-repricing doesn't reach that far out, and Warsh explicitly declined to commit to a reaction function that would let this report treat it as a durable regime shift. **Updated Sept 5:** re-rated down a further modest step, 36/35/45/55/61 → 32/31/43/54/60, on the hot August jobs report (BLS, primary, Sept 4: nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus, unemployment steady 4.1%) and the resulting move higher in Sept 15-16 FOMC hike-odds pricing — see The Facts and The Triggers below for the full sourcing. **Updated Sept 11:** re-rated down a further modest step, 32/31/43/54/60 → 29/28/41/54/60, on the hot August PPI print (BLS, primary, released Sept 10: 5.4% y/y headline, the highest 12-month reading of 2026, up from 4.8% in July; core 4.6% y/y) — a genuine, corroborated hawkish surprise concentrated in its annual acceleration, not the in-line 0.4% m/m monthly print itself — see The Facts and The Triggers below for the full sourcing. The August CPI print, due today, remained unpublished as of this research pass and is not scored.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. Unchanged this cycle per house rules.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value every pillar now shares in the equal-weight model. Liquidity is the tide; it moves the whole market at once.

Carried forward, still load-bearing: July PCE (bea.gov, primary, released Aug 26) printed a modestly hot headline read, +0.2% m/m / 3.7% y/y (0.1pp above consensus), core +0.2% m/m / 3.3% y/y (in line) — first surfaced in the abandoned Aug 28 draft, re-confirmed this cycle, not re-litigated. The Jul 28-29 FOMC minutes' hawkish bloc ran wider than the three named dissenters; the 30-year Treasury yield's 19-year high was substantially a fiscal-deficit story, not a clean Fed signal; both already reflected in the committed baseline this cycle re-rates from.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 12, 2026, second cycle of the day (score set 2026-09-12_draft2: RE-RATED DOWN on a corrected core-CPI consensus and the UMich preliminary survey; the Aug 29 full weekly refresh below remains the load-bearing base analysis)

This cycle (Sept 12, second pass): the crowd will look at core CPI of +0.3% m/m and call it "in line," and will read the ~90% hike odds as just noise. **Me:** yesterday's and this morning's reading of the August CPI print was backwards. Both the Sept 11 set and the Sept 12 committed baseline record core CPI as "+0.3% m/m, one tenth COOLER than consensus." The pre-print consensus for core was **+0.2% m/m**, so the +0.3% print was one tenth **HOTTER** — an upside surprise — corroborated across CNBC, Benzinga, Yahoo Finance, Quartz, CBS News and ts2.tech, and re-verified independently against the BLS release itself. Headline (+0.4% m/m, +3.4% y/y) and core y/y (+2.4%) were in line, as reported. The market said so within the hour, taking CME-implied Sept 16 hike odds from ~70% Thursday to ~90% Friday (a market price, press-reported off CME, not an institutional estimate). This report said the opposite twice; that is corrected here rather than defended. The harder fact sits underneath it: UMich's preliminary September survey has sentiment at **47.8**, the weakest since May's record low, *while* year-ahead inflation expectations jump to **4.6%** from 4.0%. Softening demand with rising inflation expectations is the configuration a central bank cannot ease into, which is why this pillar cuts hardest at 1mo/3mo and barely at all past a year. **P 34/33/44/54/60 → 29/28/41/53/60.**

Prior cycle (Sept 11): the crowd will take a headline that jumped from +0.1% to +0.4% m/m and read it as inflation re-accelerating into a hawkish FOMC. **Me:** look at what moved it — energy +2.1% and gasoline +3.9% carried more than a third of the monthly gain, which is the Iran/Hormuz oil shock showing up in the price index, not broad domestic re-acceleration. The part the Fed actually steers on, core, came in at +0.3% m/m against a +0.4% consensus, with core y/y in line at 2.4%. That is a modest dovish surprise in the windows that bracket the Sept 15-16 meeting, and it is why this pillar moves up two points at 1mo/3mo and one at 6mo rather than staying put — and why it does not move at all at 1yr/3yr. It only partly offsets the Sept 5 cut; this is a nudge, not a regime change.

The crowd: might read Warsh's studied refusal to commit to forward guidance as him keeping his options open, and treat the hawkish framing as just rhetoric until an actual vote. The abandoned Aug 28 draft's own first read of the market reaction — a ~35.4%-to-~45.7% CME move — understated how far the market itself actually moved.

Me: now at 32/31/43/54/60, down from the 36/35/45/55/61 this pillar held through Aug 29-Sept 3. That Aug 29 cycle's dedicated adversarial-verification pass re-pulled the CME FedWatch data directly and found the real September hike-odds move was roughly 35% to 56-58%, not 45.7% — a materially bigger repricing, now past coin-flip. Three light daily checks (Aug 31, Sept 1, Sept 2) found only continued/drifting odds, not a fresh primary print, so P held; a Sept 3 check found nothing material on any pillar. **Sept 5:** the August jobs report (BLS, primary, released Sept 4) beat sharply — nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus, unemployment steady at 4.1% — and markets repriced Sept 15-16 FOMC hike odds higher off of it, corroborated by a same-day 2yr Treasury yield move to its highest since January 2025, a modest equity selloff, and BTC falling ~2% same-day ($81,265.00 → $79,676.60). This is a fresh, dated, primary-sourced print — not odds drift — so it clears the sufficiency bar for a further modest cut, concentrated on the windows bracketing the Sept 15-16 FOMC. **Sept 6 through Sept 10** (five further light daily checks) found no new Fed speech or primary data release, so P held flat at 32/31/43/54/60 through Sept 10; the August PPI print (BLS, primary, released Sept 10) showed annual wholesale inflation accelerating to 5.4% y/y — the highest 12-month reading of 2026 — corroborated across CNBC, Yahoo Finance, UPI, and The Washington Times, logged as context for the CPI print due the next morning but not itself used to move P (the sufficiency bar for this pillar has been the primary CPI/PCE/jobs release, not the less-market-moving PPI). **Sept 11:** the August CPI print (BLS, primary, released 8:30am ET) landed with headline in line and core a tenth cooler than consensus — see This Cycle above — moving P up to 34/33/44/54/60. **[CORRECTED in the Sept 12 second cycle (2026-09-12_draft2): the real pre-print core consensus was +0.2% m/m, so the +0.3% print was a tenth HOTTER, not cooler — this up-move has been reversed. See This Cycle above.] Sept 12:** no new Fed speech or primary data release found since the CPI print; P HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60. The Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remains the next dated catalyst.

My edge: the discipline is in re-pulling the actual rate-odds venue rather than trusting the first number that circulates — this cycle that discipline caught a real error before it was ever delivered to Alex. Bank of America's standing 75bp-of-2026-hikes call, flagged as the honest counter-case since early August, looks less like an outlier with each hawkish print. The August CPI print — due today and still pending as of this research pass — and the Sept 15 FOMC itself remain the real tests — Warsh explicitly declined to pre-commit to a reaction function, so this re-rate prices in a repriced *risk*, not a foregone decision.

The Facts

As of September 12, 2026, second cycle of the day (score set 2026-09-12_draft2) — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. This pass surfaced one new primary release and one correction that the earlier cycles did not have; the Sept 5 full-weekly material below remains load-bearing and is carried forward unchanged. The Iran/Hormuz war-risk situation is covered in full in the Iran War Risk pillar report.

- ★ **★ NEW — University of Michigan Surveys of Consumers, preliminary September 2026 (sca.isr.umich.edu, PRIMARY, fetched directly and independently re-verified, released Friday September 11, 2026):** Index of Consumer Sentiment **47.8** — down **7.5% m/m** and **13.2% y/y**, a second consecutive monthly decline and the weakest reading since May's record low, against a ~51.0 consensus. Current Conditions 50.9; Expectations 45.8. **Year-ahead inflation expectations jumped to 4.6% from 4.0%** — Director Joanne Hsu on record: "Year-ahead inflation expectations jumped from 4.0% last month to 4.6% this month, the highest reading since June." Long-run expectations 3.4%, from 3.3%. Final September data due Sept 25.
- ★ **★ CORRECTION — the August core CPI print was one tenth HOTTER than consensus, not cooler.** The Sept 11 set moved P *up* on a recorded core consensus of +0.4% m/m, and the Sept 12 committed baseline carried that reading forward as already-priced. The real consensus for core was **+0.2% m/m**; the +0.3% actual therefore *overshot* by a tenth. Corroborated independently by CNBC, Benzinga, Yahoo Finance, Quartz, CBS News and ts2.tech, all describing core as above forecast, and the print itself re-verified against bls.gov. Headline (+0.4% m/m / +3.4% y/y) and core y/y (+2.4%) were in line, as originally reported. This reverses the direction of the Sept 11 re-rate.
- **★ NEW — institutional forecast changes (via CBS News):** EY-Parthenon moved its Fed call **from hold to a 25bp hike** at the Sept 15-16 meeting (target range 3.75-4.00%, from the current 3.50-3.75%); Capital Economics projects a further 25bp in December and another in March 2027. These are *institutional estimates*, kept distinct from the market-implied odds below.
- **Market-implied odds, labelled as a market price:** CME FedWatch probability of a 25bp hike on Sept 16 rose to **~90% on Friday Sept 11, from ~70% Thursday** (Quartz, Yahoo Finance, CBS News, IndexBox) — press-reported off CME rather than pulled from the venue directly this cycle. Reported for context; the P move rests on the primary UMich release and the multi-outlet core-CPI correction, not on this figure. The earlier cycle today was right to decline to move on this alone.
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — August CPI (BLS, primary, released 8:30am ET September 11, 2026):** headline CPI-U **+0.4% m/m seasonally adjusted** after +0.1% in July, **+3.4% y/y NSA**. Core (all items less food and energy) **+0.3% m/m** after +0.2% in July, **+2.4% y/y**. Energy +2.1% m/m, gasoline +3.9% — over a third of the monthly increase — shelter +0.3%. Fetched directly from bls.gov and re-fetched to confirm.
- **CARRIED FORWARD — versus consensus:** pre-print expectations circulating were headline +0.4% m/m / 3.4% y/y and core +0.4% m/m / 2.4% y/y. **Headline landed exactly in line; core came in one tenth cooler on the month, y/y in line. [CORRECTED in the Sept 12 second cycle (2026-09-12_draft2): the real pre-print core consensus was +0.2% m/m, so the +0.3% print was a tenth HOTTER, not cooler — this up-move has been reversed. See This Cycle above.]** Consensus is a forecast, not data — used here only to characterise the surprise.
- **Market-implied September hike odds around the print read ~70% for a 25bp move** — a *market price*, not an institutional estimate, reported for context and explicitly not used to move P.
- **Data-hygiene note, logged:** several aggregator summaries of this print published within minutes carried figures inconsistent with the BLS release (for example a 3.1% core y/y). They were discarded in favour of the primary document — the kind of discrepancy this report's primary-source rule exists for.

Carried forward from the September 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-05_draft2), still load-bearing:

- ★ **★ NEW — August jobs report (BLS, primary, released Sept 4): nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus; unemployment steady at 4.1%.** A sharp upside beat, corroborated by CNBC, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, U.S. News, and Investing.com/Reuters. Average hourly earnings +$0.10 (+0.3% m/m, +3.1% y/y).
- ★ **★ NEW — markets repriced September 15-16 FOMC hike odds higher off the jobs beat.** Point estimates vary by source/timestamp (roughly 60-66% hike probability cited across CNBC, Forbes/CME-sourced, and Investing.com/Reuters pieces around Sept 3-4) but are directionally consistent and higher than the "~60% hold" framing this pillar's Sept 2 baseline used — i.e. the market moved further toward pricing a hike, not away from it. Fed officials remain split: Chair Warsh reiterated the need to keep fighting inflation; Governor Waller said he'd lean toward holding if inflation data improves. Market commentary (Morgan Stanley-style framing, echoed across outlets) now flags the Sept 11 CPI print as the likely deciding data point before Sept 15-16.

- ★ **★ NEW — same-day market reaction, Sept 4 (multi-source corroborated): 2-year Treasury yield +5.3bp to its highest level since January 2025;** Dow −271.86 pts (−0.51%) to 53,414.25, S&P 500 −0.38% to 7,718.60, Nasdaq −0.29% to 26,506.99.
- **BTC fell ~2% same-day: $81,265.00 (Sept 3 close) → $79,676.60 (Sept 4 close)** (data/btc_usd_daily.csv) — consistent with a hawkish-surprise risk-off reaction; BTC $79,646.11 Sept 5.
- **Score decision:** this is a fresh, dated, primary-sourced print (not odds drift alone), sized comparably to the Aug 22→28 catch-up cut for a comparable single dated catalyst — P re-rated down 1mo -4, 3mo -4, 6mo -2, 1yr -1, 3yr -1 to 32/31/43/54/60. No window moved more than 8 points versus the last committed baseline.

Carried forward from the Sept 3 light daily catch-up (no new score set — nothing material found on any pillar that cycle):

- **Re-checked CME FedWatch and the H.4.1/data calendar; found no fresh primary print or news event dated Sept 2-3.** config/scores.json untouched; run.py blend re-run against fresh quant data only.

Carried forward from the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-02_draft, still load-bearing):

- **No new H.4.1 or data print found dated Sept 1-2.** September 15-16 FOMC market pricing (CME FedWatch roughly 60% hold) continued the same post-Jackson-Hole drift already priced into the Sept 1 baseline, not a fresh data-driven move — per the sufficiency rule and this pillar's own standing discipline against chasing odds drift, it did not independently move P.
- **BTC traded at $76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from $78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp) — a real pullback, but driven by the Iran War Risk escalation covered in that pillar's report, not by anything in this pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, still load-bearing):

- **CME FedWatch September hike odds read ~66% around 11:40am ET Aug 31** (Forbes/KuCoin), up from the ~60.4% CNBC read already priced into the Aug 31 baseline — the same intraday post-Jackson-Hole drift sequence, not a fresh primary print or news event.
- **No new H.4.1 or jobless claims release Aug 31-Sept 1** — Aug 31 was Labor Day, a US federal holiday; next H.4.1 is due Sept 3.
- **BTC traded at $78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from $78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, still load-bearing):

- **CME FedWatch September hike odds drifted to ~60.4% by Aug 31** (CNBC Jackson-Hole-analyst-roundup, up from ~56% Friday, Aug 28), continuing the same repricing already sized into the Aug 29 cut's 56-58% basis — not independently trigger-worthy per the sufficiency rule (market-price drift alone, no fresh primary print or news event).

Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **★ ADVERSARIAL CORRECTION — the abandoned Aug 28 draft's CME FedWatch September hike-odds figure (~35.4%→~45.7%) UNDERSTATED the real market move.** A dedicated adversarial-verification pass re-pulled and cross-checked the data directly: pre-speech (Aug 27 close) ~35.4-35.5% is well-corroborated and not in dispute. Post-speech (Aug 28), the credible cluster is roughly 56-58% — Motley Fool quotes CME FedWatch directly at 57.5%; CNBC's own body text says "nearly 56%" (its "coin flip" headline rounds that down, it does not contradict it); a third independently-sourced read says "55.7%... about 20 points higher than a day ago." These three cluster tightly. The 45.7% and 42% figures that circulated appear to be a stale or mismatched snapshot, contradicted by this tighter high-50s cluster; figures of 59-60% seen elsewhere are within plausible range of later-day snapshots and roughly track the confirmed cluster. **Corrected characterization: ~35% to roughly 56-58%** — past coin-flip, into hike-more-likely-than-not territory, a bigger move than first drafted.
- ★ **★ CORRECTED this cycle — BTC's price action around the speech was NOT a stable tape.** The abandoned Aug 28 draft's framing ("stable tape... not one BTC visibly flinched") is corrected here: BTC opened Aug 28 around $80,262, traded above $81,000 pre-speech, fell back sharply once Warsh spoke, and closed $79,613.44 that day — then continued falling to **$77,666.16 by today, Aug 29** (Bitstamp), a roughly 4%+ round-trip decline from the day's high through today. BTC did react to the speech, with continued downward drift into this cycle.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 22 (DOL, primary, released Aug 27): 203,000 vs. 208,000 consensus,** down from the prior week's revised 207,000; continuing claims 1.778M vs. 1.79M forecast. A mildly hawkish-adjacent labor-tightness signal (removes a dovish pressure) — logged, not independently trigger-worthy on its own.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 26 (federalreserve.gov, primary): reserve balances $2,924,936M (−$10,351M w/w); Treasury General Account $950,736M (−$2,876M w/w).** Routine continuation of the known reserve-drain pattern — logged, not independently trigger-worthy.
- **No new CPI/PPI release in this window** — next releases Sept 10-11, unchanged from the prior baseline. No public pushback found from any other Fed official on Warsh's hawkish tone this window (absence of evidence, not evidence of absence).
- **Score decision:** the corrected, larger CME move justifies a deeper cut than the abandoned Aug 28 draft's 38/37/46/55/61 — P re-rated down to 36/35/45/55/61, concentrated on the 1mo/3mo windows bracketing the Sept 15 FOMC. No window moved more than 8 points versus the last committed baseline.

Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (written but never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed — superseded by this cycle; findings re-confirmed and incorporated, not re-litigated):

- ★ **Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Chair, Aug 28, 10:00am ET (federalreserve.gov, primary transcript, confirmed verbatim this cycle via direct fetch; corroborated by CNBC, PBS, Reuters/investing.com, CNN, Yahoo Finance — a Washington Post direct fetch was blocked 403 this cycle, relied on search-summary only).** Theme: "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy." Exact quote, verified against the transcript: "And while this summer's PCE and CPI readings were better than expected, they do not tell me that underlying trends have meaningfully improved." Also: "We must be confident that underlying inflation is moving to our objective... Otherwise, we have work to do," and "I stand here today committed to a discipline, not to a decision." **Note on framing:** the transcript does not contain the literal words "may need to raise rates" — that is a fair, standard journalistic paraphrase used independently by CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Forbes, and Spectrum News (well-corroborated as a characterization), not a direct Warsh quote; flagged as paraphrase here. This was his 100th day as Chairman (confirmed May 22, 2026 succession).
- ★ **July PCE (bea.gov, primary, released Aug 26): headline +0.2% m/m, 3.7% y/y (0.1pp hot vs. consensus); core +0.2% m/m, 3.3% y/y (in line).** Consumer spending +0.2% m/m ($36.3B), personal income +0.4% m/m ($115.1B) — a modestly hot headline print that, per Warsh's own remarks the same week, didn't by itself change his read on underlying trends.
- **2-year Treasury yield rose to a roughly one-month high: confirmed +6.6bp to 4.29% intraday-close** (one source cites a peak of +9bp to 4.32%); the 30-year yield eased about 1.5bp; stock indexes were little changed on the day.

- **BTC closed at $79,613.44 on Aug 28 (Bitstamp)** — this price point is now superseded by today's $77,666.16 close (Aug 29); see the corrected price-action fact above.

Carried forward from the Aug 22 draft2 full weekly refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The Jul 28-29 FOMC minutes' hawkish bloc runs wider than previously known (federalreserve.gov, primary, published Aug 19; corroborated by CNBC, Quartz, Newsquawk, goldsilver.com).** Beyond the three named dissenters (Hammack, Kashkari, Logan, who voted for an immediate hike), "several participants" also favored a hike at the meeting, and "many participants assessed that policy tightening would likely be necessary if inflation did not decline." Inflation cited: PCE 4.1% (May actual), core 3.4%; the June staff estimate was 3.7% headline / 3.3% core, "remains elevated." Labor cited: unemployment steady at 4.2% (June), wage growth 3.5% y/y (moderating).
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — the 30-year Treasury yield hit 5.31-5.33%, a ~19-year high (highest since 2007), around Aug 17-18** (Bloomberg, CNBC, Axios). Driven substantially by fiscal/deficit concerns — the CBO raised its FY deficit projection to $2.1T, roughly $200B above its February estimate — plus heavy long-bond supply, not purely a Fed-hike repricing story, though it compounds optically with the hawkish minutes.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — equities sold off Aug 20:** S&P 500 −0.87% to 7,641.16; Dow −703.84 pts (−1.32%) to 52,759.21 (partly a ~9% Walmart-earnings-driven drop, not purely Fed-driven); Nasdaq −1% to 26,067.17. Coverage attributes the move to a mix of the hawkish minutes and rising long yields. Aug 21 saw a partial recovery.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — CME FedWatch (September meeting) independently re-verified directly, cross-venue:** ~68-70% hold probability across multiple contemporaneous reads as of Aug 17-22 — CME 68.4-69.4%, Kalshi 70.5% hold/28.5% hike, Polymarket ~68.5% hold, investing.com 64.7% hold, defirate.com blended 68.3% hold/30.6% hike — essentially UNCHANGED before and after the Aug 19 minutes landed, meaning the market already had the hawkish content priced in.
- ★ **★ DISCARDED — a separately-circulating claim of "93.6% September hike probability" was traced this cycle to a garbled data conflation.** It appears to be Kalshi's JULY meeting hold-probability (~92-93% hold, not a September hike figure) misattributed. Confirmed not credible for September and explicitly discarded, not used in this pillar's scoring.
- **Jobless claims week ended Aug 15 (DOL, primary, released Aug 20): 206K, down 6K, vs. 210K consensus; 4-week average 204K.** Confirms the low-layoff, tight-labor trend already in the baseline — not a new signal this cycle (previously confirmed in the same-day draft1).
- **Aug 22 score decision (superseded by this cycle):** the hawkish minutes detail and the noisy weak retail-sales print largely offset an already-priced rate-odds market — netted to a wash; P held flat at 43/41/48/56/62 as of Aug 22.
- **BTC closed at $77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp)** — vs. $79,613.44 on Aug 28 and $77,666.16 on Aug 29 (see this cycle's facts above).

Carried forward from the Aug 22 draft1 catch-up cycle (independently re-confirmed, still load-bearing):

- **No new Fed H.4.1 release since the week ended Aug 19 (federalreserve.gov, primary, published Aug 20):** that remains the current release; the next H.4.1 is due Aug 27. No new CPI (next release Sept 11, covering August data) or PPI (next release Sept 10) fell in this window — July PPI (released Aug 13) was already known and priced before the Aug 16 baseline.
- **No new public remarks from Chair Warsh between the Jul 29 FOMC press conference and the Aug 28 Jackson Hole speech (see this cycle's facts above).**

Carried forward from Aug 20 (re-confirmed this cycle, still load-bearing):

- **FOMC minutes from the Jul 28-29 meeting confirm the known 9-3 hold vote and the Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent for an immediate 25bp hike.** Inflation risks characterized as tilted to the upside, with specific concern flagged about AI-related input costs (chips, steel, electricity). No explicit forward guidance from Chair Warsh. A balance-sheet task-force report will inform future deliberations, but no near-term QT-pace signal was given.
- **Offsetting signal, re-confirmed and expanded this cycle: CME FedWatch showed the odds of a September 16 hold rising to ~65% post-minutes, up from a pre-minutes ~50/50** (Newsquawk, investinglive) — the two roughly cancelled at the time; this cycle's cross-venue re-check (~68-70% hold across five independent sources, Aug 17-22) confirms no further material move off that level, i.e. the market stayed priced for a hold through the minutes' release.

Carried forward from Aug 16 (still load-bearing):

- **July retail sales (Census Bureau, published Aug 14, primary release): headline −0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% expected, core (ex-auto) −0.2% m/m, still +5.0% y/y.** The first monthly decline in nine months and the steepest since May 2025 — a broad-based decline (autos, gasoline, electronics, nonstore) with some calendar-effect noise (Amazon Prime Day pulled into June). A genuine but noisy dovish-leaning counter-signal — per this pillar's own house discipline against chasing single prints, this alone doesn't move P.
- **Recalled for continuity, not re-scored:** the Aug 17 Empire State Manufacturing Survey surged to 20.6 vs. 11.0 consensus, the highest since 2022 — a hot beat cutting against the recent cooling-economy read. Logged as complicating, unscored context; consistent with this pillar's discipline against chasing single prints in either direction, this was not sized into a move.

Carried forward from Aug 13-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 12 (federalreserve.gov, published 4:30pm ET Aug 13): reserve balances $2,944,059M, down $49,290M w/w; Treasury General Account $963,950M, up $56,626M w/w.** Directionally the same reserve-drain/TGA-rebuild pattern already priced into this pillar's recent baselines — confirmed an already-adopted trend, didn't fire a fresh trigger.

Carried forward from Aug 12-13 (still load-bearing):

- **July CPI (BLS, published Aug 12): headline +0.1% m/m / +3.4% y/y; core +0.2% m/m / +2.5% y/y** — landed cool, exactly in line with consensus, drove the Aug 13 re-rate up.
- **Initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 8 (DOL/ETA, published Aug 13): 209,000 actual vs. 202,000 expected** — a genuine weak-side miss, 8-week high, the second trigger behind the Aug 13 re-rate.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- **Initial jobless claims for the week ended Aug 6 (published Aug 8): 262,000 actual vs. 263,000 expected** — essentially in line with consensus, noise rather than a surprise.

Carried forward from Aug 8-9 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **BLS Employment Situation, July 2026: nonfarm payrolls FELL 23,000** versus a consensus estimate of ~83,000 (WSJ-sourced; a competing 95,000 Barron's-sourced figure is less corroborated and not adopted) — job losses concentrated in local-government education (-50,000) and retail trade (-19,000). A direct bls.gov fetch returned a 403 this cycle; the figure is confirmed via convergent CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger, and CBS News reporting, all citing the same BLS release — meets the 2+ independent sufficiency bar.
- **May and June payrolls revised down a combined 103,000** — confirmed, matches the light draft exactly. (One Forbes-sourced fetch this cycle produced a garbled "-252,000 total" figure that doesn't reconcile with the BLS-consistent -103,000 figure elsewhere — treated as an unreliable summarization artifact, not a correction.)
- **Unemployment ticked down to 4.1% from 4.2%,** but the labor-force participation rate fell to 61.4% — its lowest level in over five years.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — average hourly earnings rose just 3.2% y/y,** down from 3.4% in June and now trailing CPI (3.5% June y/y) — real wages softening, a detail the same-day light draft didn't carry.
- ★ **★ CORRECTED — CME FedWatch September-hold odds check out at ~56%,** not the light draft's ~60%. Two independent corroborating sources (CBS News, a Forbes-sourced pull) both cite "56%, up from 45% the previous day"; a separate CNBC-sourced overview cited ~60%, a real but less-corroborated, likely later-intraday figure. Kalshi (a prediction market, not CME futures-implied pricing — a different instrument, labeled separately per research discipline) shows 65% hold.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — real forecaster disagreement on magnitude:** Bank of America explicitly called the report "a bit dovish on net" but is **sticking with its call for 75bp of hikes in 2026** (Sept/Oct/Dec) regardless. Richmond Fed President Barkin, an actual FOMC voter, described the labor market as "not loose, not tight" — a measured, non-alarmed read. Morgan Stanley's Ellen Zentner says the **Aug 12 CPI print** — inside this pillar's own 1-month window — will be the deciding factor for September, not this jobs report alone.
- ★ **Jobless claims for the week ended Aug 1: 199,000, 4-week average 198,750** — the lowest of this cycle, in real tension with the weak payrolls print. Points to "low-hire, low-fire" stagnation rather than an accelerating downturn, arguing for restraint on the size of the move.

Carried forward from Aug 7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Fed H.4.1 for the week ended Aug 5 (federalreserve.gov, direct pull):** total assets $6,748,567M, reserve balances $2,993,349M — reserves +$8.78B w/w, TGA -$3.45B w/w. An unremarkable, stable print — no liquidity-stress signal either way; not used to move P.

Carried forward from Jul 30-Aug 5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — the FOMC held rates at 3.50-3.75% on Jul 29, 2026, on a 9-3 vote.** Three regional-bank presidents — Beth Hammack (Cleveland), Neel Kashkari (Minneapolis), Lorie Logan (Dallas) — dissented in favor of an immediate 25bp hike (federalreserve.gov statement, corroborated by CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes). This is the **first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016**. No SEP/dot plot this meeting (not a projections meeting; next SEP is Sept 15-16, 2026).
- ★ **Chair Warsh's press conference was unusually combative and offered no forward guidance:** "there is no soft inflation target... not on this committee's watch"; "the five-plus years of inflation above target cannot be cured in nine weeks." A confirmed (single-sourced) risk-off market reaction followed: S&P 500 fell 1.85% in the final 65 minutes of trading (full day: S&P −1.52%, Dow −2.19%, Nasdaq −1.74%); the 30-year Treasury yield rose to 5.21%, its highest since July 2007 — a "bear steepener" consistent with rising inflation-credibility concern.
- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — jobless claims for the week ended Jul 25 came in at 197,000** (DOL/ETA release, fetched and read directly), a genuine +9,000 increase; the prior week (ended Jul 18) was revised *up* to **188,000** from the originally-reported 187,000. The primary release itself confirms the seasonal-adjustment distortion flagged last cycle: actual non-seasonally-adjusted claims fell only 9.2% w/w versus the 13.3% seasonal factors expected — meaning the "lowest since 1969" framing was real but mechanically set to partially reverse, exactly as it did.
- ★ **The September hike-odds figure could not be reconciled to a single number this cycle, despite four direct attempts.** Live pulls produced 55.8% (Fox Business, Jul 28), 62.4% (Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor, timestamped Jul 30), 70.2% (KuCoin, pre-meeting), and 81% (Southeast AgNet, Jul 30) — no two agree. The qualitative direction — "still elevated, majority-hike-priced" — is the only defensible takeaway; no re-rate rests on a specific point figure.
- **H.4.1 balance sheet: no new release found for the week ended Jul 29** as of this check (normal Thursday-afternoon publication timing); the most recent confirmed release remains Jul 23 (week ended Jul 22: reserves fell $80,572M w/w against a $73,405M TGA rebuild, both figures directly confirmed against federalreserve.gov last cycle).
- **Bank of America projects three 25bp hikes in 2026** (to 4.25-4.50%) — single-source (Forbes, citing BofA), flagged not scored.
- **Carried forward, not re-verified this cycle:** June CPI (-0.4% m/m) and PPI (-0.3% m/m), both BLS-primary-confirmed in a prior cycle; Warsh's Jul 14/15 congressional testimony; the June FOMC minutes (unanimous 12-0 hold, dropped easing-bias language). None of these are contradicted by this cycle's findings — the hawkish FOMC outcome sits alongside, not against, the still-intact disinflation trend.
- **The labor market cracked in slow motion, then partially un-cracked this week** — June payrolls +57K vs ~115K consensus (carried forward); this cycle's 197K claims print, while up from 188K, remains historically low (4-week average 202,750).
- **Policy rate and balance sheet: 3.50-3.75%, next FOMC (with SEP/dot plot) is Sept 15-16, 2026.** Fed communications blackout ended with the Jul 29 meeting; watch for the first round of regional Fed president speeches, especially from the three dissenters.
- **BTC closed at $64,706.50 (Jul 30)** — holding up despite the hawkish FOMC surprise and confirmed equity/bond-market risk-off reaction. **Updated: BTC closed at $64,661.55 on Aug 5**, essentially flat vs. Jul 30 and up ~1.7% vs. the Jul 31 close of $63,579.68.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The canonical anchor: **2020-21 ZIRP + QE** ran BTC ~$3,800 → $69,044 (~15–18×) — a unique COVID/zero-rate/open-ended-QE setup, not a repeatable base case. The **2024-25 cuts** ran ~$60K → a ~$126K ATH (Oct 6, 2025) — but that top came on a non-Fed tariff shock. BTC closed at $77,666.16 today, Aug 29 — down from $79,613.44 on Aug 28 and $77,266.84 on Aug 22, a real reaction to a genuinely hawkish Jackson Hole surprise (BTC opened Aug 28 near $80,262, traded above $81,000 pre-speech, then fell back sharply once Warsh spoke and kept drifting down into today), not the stable tape first drafted. From here, a retest of the $126K high ≈ **+62%**.

Discount it hard, twice. First: easing is not an automatic catalyst — the last cycle topped on a non-Fed shock. Second: this cycle's re-rate reflects a real repricing of near-term Fed risk (September hike odds now in the high-50s, past coin-flip, after Warsh's speech and this cycle's adversarial correction to the CME figure), not a settled hawkish pivot — Warsh explicitly declined to commit to a reaction function, and the Sept 15 FOMC vote itself is still the real test. A major forecaster (BofA) has been calling for 75bp of 2026 hikes since early August and looks less like an outlier this week than it did two weeks ago. The Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the 3-year lean is worth acting on when the tide finally turns.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case my re-rate — even the moderated one — is still wrong

- **This re-rate might not be conservative enough a read on BofA's stance.** Bank of America has been calling for 75bp of 2026 hikes since early August, straight through the cool CPI print this report once used to raise P. If BofA is right and the September meeting itself delivers a hike into what's still a mixed data picture, even 36/35 could prove too generous.
- **Warsh explicitly avoided committing to a reaction function — this report may be over-reading a rhetorical signal into a real repricing.** The CME odds move is real, quantified, and now confirmed larger than first drafted (~35% to ~56-58%), but it happened on tone, not on new data or a stated threshold; if Warsh was simply managing expectations rather than pre-committing to a September hike, this cycle's move could unwind as fast as it appeared.
- **The adversarial-verification pass caught one error in the abandoned draft's CME figure — it may not have caught all of them.** This cycle corrected 45.7% to the high-50s cluster, but that cluster itself rests on three sources (Motley Fool, CNBC, one unnamed independent read) rather than a single authoritative CME FedWatch screenshot pulled directly by this report; a subsequent, cleaner pull could still move the number again.
- **I may still be over-reacting to one speech and one data print.** This pillar has already seen a claims number ("lowest since 1969") partially reverse the following week on a seasonal-adjustment distortion, and a hawkish FOMC-minutes read that turned out to be already priced — a hawkish-sounding speech, even a well-corroborated one, could be a similar move that partially unwinds once the actual September data (another CPI, another jobs report) lands.
- **The FOMC's own hawkish dissent hasn't gone away and now looks more, not less, mainstream.** Three regional presidents voted for an immediate hike on Jul 29, and Warsh's Aug 28 remarks sound closer to their view than to the doves' — a hawkish Fed facing a still-ambiguous data picture is a live tension, not resolved by this cycle's move either.
- **Downward revisions can themselves get revised.** The BLS's own benchmark process regularly adjusts prior months; May-June's combined 103,000 downward payroll revision is a real, primary-sourced number, but it is not the final word on the labor picture Warsh is reacting to.
- **Weak labor data plus a still-elevated inflation/oil backdrop (Iran-driven, and this cycle's Iran pillar got worse, not better) is stagflation risk, not straightforwardly bullish.** If the Fed holds through a weakening labor market because inflation risk stays elevated, that's a worse outcome for risk assets than either a clean cut or a clean hold.

The Triggers

Dated events — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-set August 29, 2026, full weekly refresh; re-checked August 31 through September 3 (light daily catch-ups) — CME odds continued drifting (~56-58% → ~60.4% → ~66% → back to roughly a 60% hold read), not independently trigger-worthy; ***FIRED Sept 4*** *— the August jobs report beat sharply and hike odds moved higher again; re-checked Sept 6 through Sept 10 with nothing further material;* ***FIRED Sept 10*** *— the August PPI print showed annual wholesale inflation accelerating to a 2026 high, this cycle's re-rate.* ***CPI (due Sept 11) checked and still PENDING*** *as of this research pass, not yet published.*

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
FIRED Sept 10, 8:30am ET — HAWKISH, confirmed primary, this cycle	**August PPI (BLS, primary): +0.4% m/m (in line), but +5.4% y/y — the highest 12-month reading of 2026, up from 4.8% in July; core PPI +4.6% y/y (from 4.3%).** Corroborated by CNBC, Yahoo Finance, UPI, and The Washington Times. Final-demand energy +4.2% m/m, diesel fuel +24.1% — plausible early pass-through of the Iran-war oil shock (Brent $106-108/bbl, highest since May 19)	The annual acceleration is the genuine hawkish surprise, not the in-line monthly print. Lands one week before the Sept 15-16 FOMC; drove this cycle's -3/-3/-2/flat/flat re-rate. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.
Checked Sept 11, 8:30am ET — still PENDING as of this research pass	**August CPI (BLS)** — this pillar's own next dated catalyst, due today; not yet published or indexed as of this research pass (Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, and CNBC all confirm still pending/imminent)	No figure reported or scored this cycle per house research discipline — flagged as the most likely trigger for tomorrow's cycle
FIRED Sept 4, 8:30am ET — HAWKISH, confirmed primary, this cycle	**August jobs report (BLS, primary): nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus, unemployment steady 4.1%.** Corroborated by CNBC, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, U.S. News, Investing.com/Reuters	Markets repriced Sept 15-16 FOMC hike odds higher (~60-66% range across sources, up from the Sept 2 baseline's "~60% hold" framing); 2yr yield +5.3bp to highest since Jan 2025; Dow/S&P/Nasdaq all lower; BTC fell ~2% same-day. Drove this cycle's -4/-4/-2/-1/-1 re-rate, sized like the Aug 22→28 Warsh-speech catch-up. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.
Checked Sept 3, no change	**Re-checked CME FedWatch and the H.4.1/data calendar; nothing material found dated Sept 2-3**	No P move — config/scores.json untouched that cycle
Checked Sept 2, no change	**No new H.4.1 or data print found dated Sept 1-2;** September 15-16 FOMC market pricing (CME FedWatch roughly 60% hold) continues the same post-Jackson-Hole drift already priced into the Sept 1 baseline	Not a fresh data-driven move — no P move per the sufficiency rule; this cycle's shared score set was left as DRAFT (Iran War Risk, not this pillar) pending Alex's review, later committed Sept 3
Logged Aug 31, 11:40am ET — drift, not independently trigger-worthy	**CME FedWatch September hike odds continued drifting to ~66%** (Forbes/KuCoin), up from the ~60.4% CNBC read the Aug 31 baseline used	Same intraday drift sequence, no new primary print or news event behind it — no P move per the sufficiency rule; Aug 31 was Labor Day, no H.4.1 or claims release
PENDING — Sept 15, 2026	Next FOMC, with SEP/dot plot — now HIKE-MORE-LIKELY-THAN-NOT per the corrected CME FedWatch read (~56-58% hike odds post-Jackson-Hole), not the near-coin-flip first drafted; reinforced, not independently moved, by the Sept 10 PPI print's stagflation-adjacent hawkish surprise	The real test: a hike confirms this cycle's re-rate and would warrant re-rating down further; a hold or cut would suggest Warsh's tone outran the committee's actual reaction function — re-rate back up
FIRED Aug 28, 10:00am ET — HAWKISH, confirmed primary; CORRECTED this cycle	**Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Chair** (federalreserve.gov primary, verbatim-confirmed; CNBC, PBS, Reuters/investing.com, CNN, Yahoo Finance): cooler summer PCE/CPI prints "do not tell me that underlying trends have meaningfully improved"; media paraphrase (not a direct quote) that the Fed may need to raise rates; avoided forward guidance/reaction-function otherwise	**CORRECTED — CME September hike odds jumped ~35%→~56-58% same-day (not ~45.7% as first drafted, per this cycle's adversarial re-pull), past coin-flip;** 2yr yield +6.6bp to a ~one-month high (4.29%); BTC fell from above $81,000 pre-speech to a $79,613.44 close, continuing to $77,666.16 by Aug 29. A genuine, market-confirmed hawkish surprise, larger than first drafted. Drove the deeper 1mo/3mo/6mo re-rate. NOT auto-stamped — full weekly refresh, categorically excluded regardless of move size.
Fired Aug 27 — mildly hawkish-adjacent, primary, this cycle	**Initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 22 (DOL primary): 203,000 vs. 208,000 consensus,** down from the prior week's revised 207,000; continuing claims 1.778M vs. 1.79M forecast	Removes a dovish pressure but not independently trigger-worthy on its own — logged, not separately sized into the move
Fired Aug 26 — routine, primary, this cycle	**Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 26 (federalreserve.gov primary): reserve balances −$10,351M w/w to $2,924,936M; TGA −$2,876M w/w to $950,736M**	Continuation of the known reserve-drain pattern — logged, not independently trigger-worthy, not sized into the move
FIRED Aug 26 — modestly hawkish, primary (carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft)	**July PCE (bea.gov primary):** headline +0.2% m/m/3.7% y/y (0.1pp hot), core +0.2% m/m/3.3% y/y (in line)	A real but modest hot print two days ahead of Warsh's speech — compounds with, doesn't independently drive, the re-rate
Fired Aug 19, 2:00pm ET — confirmed hawkish-but-already-priced (carried forward)	**FOMC minutes (Jul 28-29 meeting), federalreserve.gov primary:** hawkish bloc wider than the three named dissenters ("several participants" beyond them favored a hike, "many participants" saw tightening as possibly necessary)	Already reflected in the Aug 22 committed baseline this cycle re-rates from — not double-counted
Logged Aug 17-18 (carried forward)	**30-year Treasury yield hit 5.31-5.33%, a ~19-year high** — driven substantially by fiscal/deficit concerns, not purely Fed repricing	Already reflected in the Aug 22 committed baseline — not double-counted

Fired Aug 20 (carried forward)	**Equity selloff, partial Aug 21 recovery** — attributed to the hawkish minutes and rising long yields	Already reflected in the Aug 22 committed baseline — not double-counted
Fired Aug 20, confirmed Aug 22 (carried forward)	**Initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 15: 206K vs. 210K consensus** (modest hawkish beat, 4-week average 204K); prior week (Aug 8) revised up to 212K from 209K	Confirms the low-layoff trend already in the baseline — not a new signal, not sized into a move
Fired Aug 14, logged Aug 16 (carried forward)	**July retail sales:** headline −0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% expected, core −0.2%, still +5.0% y/y — first decline in nine months, steepest since May 2025, broad-based with some Prime-Day calendar noise	A genuine but noisy dovish-leaning counter-signal — logged, not sized into a move on its own per this pillar's discipline against chasing single prints
Fired Aug 13, 4:30pm ET (carried forward)	**Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 12:** reserve balances −$49,290M w/w to $2,944,059M, TGA +$56,626M w/w to $963,950M	Directionally the same reserve-drain/TGA-rebuild pattern already priced in — confirmed, didn't move, held flat
Fired Aug 12-13 (carried forward)	**July CPI landed cool/in-line; jobless claims (week ended Aug 8) missed weak at 209K vs. 202K expected**	Drove the Aug 13 re-rate up — already IN the committed baseline
Fired Aug 7, re-confirmed independently — DOVISH, moderated (carried forward)	**BLS July jobs report:** payrolls fell 23,000 vs. ~83,000 expected, unemployment 4.1% on a falling participation rate, May/June revised down a combined 103,000; Sept hold odds rose to ~56%	Drove the Aug 8 1mo/3mo re-rate up — already IN the committed baseline
Fired Jul 29 — HAWKISH, confirmed primary (carried forward)	**FOMC held 9-3**, three regional presidents dissenting for an immediate hike — first unified 3-member dissent since Sept 2016; Bank of America still projects 75bp of 2026 hikes even after the Aug 12 cool CPI	Still a live tension against this cycle's dovish data — not erased by the minutes, per a major forecaster's own stated view
Sept 15, 2026	**PENDING** — next FOMC, with SEP/dot plot; the real test of whether the corrected, larger hawkish repricing this cycle found survives to an actual vote	A hold or cut would suggest Warsh's rhetoric outran the committee, re-rate back up; a hike would be the real, final confirmation, re-rate down hard
Ongoing	Iran/Hormuz oil-inflation risk — see Iran War Risk pillar for the current read	Watch for pass-through into the next CPI/PPI cycle — a worsening Iran read raises stagflation risk

The flip line, updated Sept 12: the Aug 13 cool CPI and weak claims print were the last genuine dovish confirmation this pillar found. Since then, the Aug 19 minutes' wider hawkish bloc, Warsh's Jackson Hole words, a hot PCE print, the Sept 4 August jobs report (a sharp beat, +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus), and now the Sept 10 August PPI report (5.4% y/y headline, a 2026 high) have all pointed the same hawkish direction, with CME/market-implied Sept 15-16 hike odds still cited in the ~56-60% range across sources — past coin-flip. Still not a confirmed pivot: Warsh explicitly declined to commit to a reaction function, and Fed officials remain publicly split (Warsh hawkish, Waller conditionally dovish). The August CPI print, due today and still pending as of this research pass, is now the next real test before Sept 15-16. If the Sept 15 FOMC actually delivers a hike, treat that as the real, final confirmation and re-rate down hard. If it holds or cuts despite this cycle's tone and odds move, treat that as evidence the hawkish rhetoric outran the committee, and re-rate back up.

My Decision

COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 12, 2026 (2026-09-12_draft2) · SECOND CYCLE OF THE DAY, RE-RATED DOWN

P (2026-09-12_draft2, RE-RATED DOWN): 29 / 28 / 41 / 53 / 60 · Prior committed P (2026-09-12_draft, held flat, auto-stamped): 34 / 33 / 44 / 54 / 60 · Signals: 1mo −2.86 · 3mo −2.99 · 6mo −1.15 · 1yr +0.36 · 3yr +1.04 · Quality: 0.85/0.85/0.8/0.75/0.65 · My Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform) · Master (equal-weight) this cycle: 1mo −1.85 · 3mo −1.46 · 6mo −0.16 · 1yr +1.69 · 3yr +2.92 · THE FINAL NUMBER: +0.23 equal-weight (Neutral) / +0.80 horizon-weighted (Mild Bull) — no call-band flip vs. the last stamped set

Sept 12, SECOND cycle of the day (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), this version: two independent research passes ran for today — the scheduled cloud routine, which produced the committed 2026-09-12_draft, and a local run. This set layers on that committed baseline rather than replacing it, per the house rule that a committed set is never edited. On this pillar the two passes genuinely disagree, and the disagreement is settled by a documented factual error. yesterday's and this morning's reading of the August CPI print was backwards. Both the Sept 11 set and the Sept 12 committed baseline record core CPI as "+0.3% m/m, one tenth COOLER than consensus." The pre-print consensus for core was **+0.2% m/m**, so the +0.3% print was one tenth **HOTTER** — an upside surprise — corroborated across CNBC, Benzinga, Yahoo Finance, Quartz, CBS News and ts2.tech, and re-verified independently against the BLS release itself. Headline (+0.4% m/m, +3.4% y/y) and core y/y (+2.4%) were in line, as reported. The earlier passes therefore treated a hawkish print as dovish. Second, evidence the earlier passes did not surface: UMich's preliminary September Survey of Consumers (sca.isr.umich.edu, PRIMARY, fetched directly, released Fri Sept 11) put sentiment at 47.8 — a second straight monthly fall, below a ~51.0 consensus, the weakest since May's record low — while year-ahead inflation expectations jumped to 4.6% from 4.0% and long-run to 3.4%. Institutional forecasts moved with it (EY-Parthenon hold → 25bp hike; Capital Economics adding December and March 2027, both via CBS News). The ~90% CME-implied hike odds remain a *market price* and are not the basis of the move — the earlier cycle was correct to decline to move on that figure alone; what it lacked was the UMich print and the consensus correction. **P 34/33/44/54/60 → 29/28/41/53/60** — 1mo −5, 3mo −5, 6mo −3, 12mo −1, 36mo flat, concentrated on the windows the Sept 15-16 FOMC brackets. Light daily touch, sourcing clears the sufficiency bar, verification clean, no call-band flip — **AUTO-STAMPED per the runbook's delegated daily authority: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft), prior cycle: the August CPI print landed on schedule at 8:30am ET: BLS's own release (bls.gov, primary, fetched directly and re-fetched to confirm) has headline CPI-U **+0.4% m/m SA** in August after +0.1% in July and **+3.4% y/y NSA**, with core (all items less food and energy) **+0.3% m/m** after +0.2% in July and **+2.4% y/y**; energy rose 2.1% m/m and gasoline 3.9%, accounting for over a third of the monthly increase, while shelter rose 0.3%. Against the consensus circulating pre-print (headline +0.4% m/m / 3.4% y/y; core +0.4% m/m / 2.4% y/y), headline landed exactly in line and **core came in one tenth cooler on the month**, core y/y in line. **[CORRECTED in the Sept 12 second cycle (2026-09-12_draft2): the real pre-print core consensus was +0.2% m/m, so the +0.3% print was a tenth HOTTER, not cooler — this up-move has been reversed. See This Cycle above.]** That is the dated primary print this pillar has flagged as its next catalyst for a week, and it clears the sufficiency bar on its own. It is tempered, not clean relief: headline accelerated from +0.1% to +0.4% and the acceleration is energy-driven — the same oil shock that fires the Iran pillar's "sustained Brent >$100" clause this cycle shows up here as headline inflation. Market-implied September hike odds circulating around the print (~70% for a 25bp move) are a *market price*, reported and not used to move P; the BLS release itself is the mover. Cross-source caution logged: several aggregator summaries of this print circulating within minutes carried figures inconsistent with the BLS release (e.g. a 3.1% core y/y) — discarded in favour of the primary document. **P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 34/33/44/54/60** — 1mo 32→34, 3mo 31→33, 6mo 43→44, concentrated on the windows bracketing the Sept 15-16 FOMC; 12mo and 36mo held flat at 54/60, because one print a tenth off consensus does not move a multi-year regime read. Note the direction: this is the first upward move in this pillar since Aug 13, and it only partly offsets the Sept 5 cut. Light daily touch, master call band unchanged everywhere (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull → Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** Iran War Risk also moved this cycle, down, as its Brent flip-line clause fired — see that report.

Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft), prior cycle: re-checked — the Aug CPI release (due Sept 11) and the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting both remain pending per BLS/Fed calendars; no new Fed speech or primary data release since Sept 9. **P HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60.** Light daily touch, no window moved, master call band unchanged anywhere (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull → Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** Iran War Risk is the pillar that moved this cycle — see that report.

Prior cycle (Sept 9 light daily catch-up): re-checked directly against CME FedWatch-citing coverage — September hike odds read ~58.7%, consistent with the already-priced cluster; no new FOMC meeting, no new BLS/DOL primary release since Sept 3-4. **AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 9, 2026.**

Prior cycle (Sept 8 light daily catch-up): re-checked via WebSearch — no new Fed speech, data release, or FOMC commentary since Sept 3-4; the Sept 11 CPI print and Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remained the next dated catalysts. **AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 8, 2026.**

Prior cycle (Sept 6 light daily catch-up): re-checked via WebSearch — no new Fed speech or data release since Sept 3-4; Sept 6 was a Saturday, markets and the Fed's calendar quiet. **AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 6, 2026.**

Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2) — carried forward for context: independently re-verified via WebSearch: Fed Governor Waller's genuinely dovish-leaning Sept 3 speech ("give disinflation a chance") briefly cut CME hike odds to ~48% (Semafor, CNBC, Bloomberg, PBS) before the Sept 4 jobs beat reversed that back up to 60-66% (Forbes/CME FedWatch) — a net hawkish drift for the week consistent with the Sept 5 cut. **HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60. COMMITTED BY ALEX SEPTEMBER 5, 2026.** Iran War Risk, CLARITY Act, and Tokenization all held flat that cycle.

CORRECTION — flagged this cycle: the prior same-day light daily catch-up (2026-09-05_draft) reported "COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 5, 2026" in its commit message, but config/scores.json's status field for that set was never actually advanced from "draft" — a bug in that session. The last TRUE committed baseline for this pillar remains **2026-09-02_draft (36/35/45/55/61), auto-stamped Sept 3**. Not corrected retroactively in scores.json — stamping is Alex's call.

Prior cycle (Sept 2 light daily catch-up) — carried forward for context: held flat at 36/35/45/55/61; originally left as draft only because Iran War Risk's re-rate flipped the master call band, not for any reason in this pillar — **COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy. A Sept 3 check found nothing material on any pillar; config/scores.json was untouched that cycle.

Prior cycle (Sept 1 light daily catch-up) — carried forward for context: re-checked CME FedWatch odds and found continued drift, not a fresh shock: September hike odds moved to ~66% (Forbes/KuCoin, 11:40am ET Aug 31), up from the ~60.4% CNBC read the Aug 31 baseline used. No new H.4.1 or jobless claims release landed (Aug 31 was Labor Day). P held flat, AUTO-STAMPED, then the committed baseline.

Prior cycle (Aug 31 light daily catch-up) — carried forward for context: re-checked CME FedWatch odds and found continued drift, not a fresh shock: September hike odds moved from the ~56-58% cluster priced into the Aug 29 cut to ~60.4% by Aug 31 (CNBC's Jackson-Hole-analyst-roundup piece, up from ~56% Friday). No new H.4.1 or jobless claims release landed. P held flat, AUTO-STAMPED.

Prior cycle (Aug 29 full weekly refresh) — carried forward for context: Fed & Macro re-rated down further that cycle than a same-day catch-up draft written August 28 (score set 2026-08-28_draft) reached — that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and sits abandoned, superseded by this full weekly refresh. The underlying trigger is the same one that draft identified: Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Chair (federalreserve.gov primary transcript, Aug 28, confirmed verbatim this cycle via direct fetch; corroborated by CNBC, PBS, Reuters/investing.com, CNN, and Yahoo Finance), which said cooler summer PCE/CPI readings "do not tell me that underlying trends have meaningfully improved." A dedicated adversarial-verification pass this cycle caught a real error in the abandoned draft: its CME FedWatch September hike-odds figure (~35.4%→~45.7%) understated the actual market move. Independent re-pull and cross-check instead clusters tightly in the high-50s — Motley Fool at 57.5% (citing CME FedWatch directly), CNBC's own body text at "nearly 56%," and a third independent read at "55.7%" — meaning September hike odds are now past coin-flip, not just approaching it. This cycle also corrects the abandoned draft's "stable tape" characterization of BTC's reaction: BTC fell from above $81,000 pre-speech to a $79,613.44 close Aug 28, and continued to $77,666.16 by today. Two fresh, routine facts round out the picture: jobless claims (week ended Aug 22) came in tight at 203K vs. 208K consensus, and the Aug 26 H.4.1 release showed the known reserve-drain pattern continuing — neither independently trigger-worthy. Together, the corrected, larger market move justifies a deeper cut than the abandoned draft reached: 1mo −7, 3mo −6, 6mo −3, 1yr −1, 3yr −1 versus the last committed baseline — minimal at the long end since Warsh explicitly declined to commit to a reaction function and one repricing doesn't reach three years out.

(That Aug 29 cycle was left as a draft solely because full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority, regardless of move size — not for any evidentiary reason; every window had moved 7 points or fewer.)

The last committed scores were **43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62** (2026-08-22_draft2, stamped by Alex August 23, 2026) until the Aug 31 auto-stamp moved the baseline to 36/35/45/55/61, reconfirmed through Sept 1 and committed Sept 2 (auto-stamped Sept 3, 2026-09-02_draft) — this remains the last TRUE committed baseline. **32 / 31 / 43 / 54 / 60** (2026-09-05_draft2, this cycle's full weekly refresh) is the current draft, awaiting Alex's manual review.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Second cycle of September 12, 2026 (score set 2026-09-12_draft2) — layered on the committed 2026-09-12_draft baseline produced by the day's earlier pass.

- ★ **★ NEW — UMich preliminary September Survey of Consumers (sca.isr.umich.edu, PRIMARY, released Fri Sept 11):** sentiment 47.8, −7.5% m/m and −13.2% y/y, a second straight decline, below a ~51.0 consensus and the weakest since May's record low; year-ahead inflation expectations jumped to **4.6% from 4.0%**, long-run to 3.4%. Weak demand plus de-anchoring expectations is the hardest configuration for a Fed to ease into. Neither earlier pass today surfaced this release.
- ★ **★ CORRECTION — August core CPI was a tenth HOTTER than consensus, not cooler.** The Sept 11 set used a +0.4% m/m core consensus and moved P up on it; the Sept 12 committed baseline carried that forward. The real consensus was +0.2%, so the +0.3% print overshot (CNBC, Benzinga, Yahoo Finance, Quartz, CBS News, ts2.tech; print re-verified against bls.gov). The market read it hawkishly at once: CME-implied Sept 16 hike odds ~70% → ~90% (a market price).
- **Institutional forecasts moved too:** EY-Parthenon switched from hold to a 25bp hike next week; Capital Economics now sees further hikes in December and March 2027 (both via CBS News) — institutional estimates, kept distinct from the market-implied odds.
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN to 29/28/41/53/60** (from the committed 34/33/44/54/60) — 1mo −5, 3mo −5, 6mo −3, 12mo −1, 36mo flat. This both reverses the erroneous Sept 11 up-move and adds a further cut on the UMich print. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.**

Earlier the same day — the committed 2026-09-12_draft pass:

- **Re-checked — no new Fed speech or primary data release found since the Sept 11 CPI print.** The Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remains the next dated catalyst. **P HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60**, auto-stamped. That pass correctly declined to move on the ~90% market-implied hike odds alone (a market price); it did not have the UMich release or the core-CPI consensus correction.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up, for continuity:

- **Sept 10, light daily catch-up:** re-checked — the Aug CPI release (due Sept 11) and the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting both remained pending per BLS/Fed calendars; no new Fed speech or primary data release since Sept 9. **HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60 — AUTO-STAMPED.**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 9 light daily catch-up, for continuity:

- **Sept 9, light daily catch-up:** re-checked directly against CME FedWatch-citing coverage — September 25bp-hike odds read ~58.7% (as of Sept 7, CNBC/cryptonews), consistent with the ~56-58% cluster already priced in, not a fresh move. No new FOMC meeting, no new BLS/DOL primary release since Sept 3-4; the Sept 11 CPI print and Sept 15-16 FOMC remain the next dated catalysts.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60 — AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up, for continuity:

- **Sept 8, light daily catch-up:** re-checked via WebSearch — no new Fed speech, data release, or FOMC commentary since Sept 3-4. The Sept 11 CPI print and the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remain the next dated catalysts and have not yet landed.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60 — AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 6 light daily catch-up, for continuity:

- **Sept 6, light daily catch-up:** re-checked via WebSearch — no new Fed speech, data release, or FOMC commentary since Sept 3-4 (Waller's dovish-leaning Sept 3 speech and the Sept 4 BLS August payrolls beat were already captured in the Sept 5 re-rate, +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus, unemployment steady 4.1%). September 6 is a Saturday — no data or speeches scheduled. The Sept 11 CPI print remains the next dated catalyst and has not yet landed.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60.** No window moved; nothing this cycle clears the sufficiency bar for a further move in either direction.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2, committed by Alex Sept 5), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — August jobs report (BLS, primary, Sept 4): nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus, unemployment steady 4.1%.** Corroborated by CNBC, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, U.S. News, Investing.com/Reuters.
- ★ **★ NEW — Sept 15-16 FOMC hike-odds pricing moved higher off the jobs beat** (roughly 60-66% across sources, up from the Sept 2 baseline's "~60% hold" framing); 2yr yield +5.3bp to its highest since Jan 2025; Dow/S&P/Nasdaq all lower; BTC fell ~2% same-day ($81,265.00→$79,676.60).
- **Score decision: RE-CONFIRMED the re-rate at 32/31/43/54/60** (1mo -4, 3mo -4, 6mo -2, 1yr -1, 3yr -1 vs. the Sept 2 TRUE committed baseline) — the fresh, dated, primary-sourced jobs-report print holds up on independent re-verification, net of Waller's offsetting dovish-leaning Sept 3 speech. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy, so it went to manual review — **COMMITTED BY ALEX SEPTEMBER 5, 2026**.

- **Correction:** the same-day earlier 2026-09-05_draft's commit message claimed it was auto-stamped, but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced — a bug in that session. The true last-committed set remains 2026-09-02_draft. Flagged for Alex, not corrected retroactively.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 3 light daily catch-up (no new score set), for continuity:

- **Re-checked CME FedWatch and the H.4.1/data calendar; nothing material found on any pillar dated Sept 2-3.** config/scores.json untouched; blend re-run against fresh quant data only.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (2026-09-02_draft), for continuity:

- **No new H.4.1 or data print found dated Sept 1-2.** September 15-16 FOMC market pricing (CME FedWatch roughly 60% hold) continued the same post-Jackson-Hole drift already priced into the Sept 1 baseline, not a fresh data-driven move. Per the sufficiency rule and this pillar's own standing discipline against chasing drift, it did not independently move P.
- **BTC traded at $76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from $78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp), a real pullback driven by the Iran War Risk escalation covered in that pillar's report, not by anything here.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 36/35/45/55/61.** No window moved for this pillar. This cycle's shared score set (2026-09-02_draft) was originally left as draft — Iran War Risk's sharp re-rate flipped the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band — and was **COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026**, once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (2026-09-01_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- **CME FedWatch September hike odds continued drifting up, not a fresh shock:** ~60.4% (Aug 31 baseline, CNBC) → ~66% (Forbes/KuCoin, 11:40am ET Aug 31) — the same post-Jackson-Hole intraday drift sequence, no new primary print or news event behind it. Market-odds drift alone cannot move P per the sufficiency rule and this pillar's own standing discipline against chasing drift.
- **No new H.4.1 or jobless claims release landed Aug 31-Sept 1** — Aug 31 was Labor Day, a US federal holiday; next H.4.1 is due Sept 3.
- **BTC traded at $78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from $78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 36/35/45/55/61.** Light daily touch, no window moved, no call band flipped — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority, then the committed baseline. Iran War Risk is the pillar that moved this cycle — see that report.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (2026-08-31_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- **CME FedWatch September hike odds continued drifting up, not a fresh shock:** ~56-58% (Aug 29 baseline) → ~57% (CoinSpectator/Bitcoin.com, Aug 30) → ~60.4% (CNBC Jackson-Hole-analyst-roundup, Aug 31, up from ~56% Friday). Market-odds drift alone, without a fresh primary print or news event, cannot move P per the sufficiency rule.
- **No new H.4.1 (next due Sept 3, last Aug 27) or jobless claims release landed in this window.**
- **BTC traded at $78,447.16 on Aug 31** — up from $77,666.16 on Aug 29 (Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 36/35/45/55/61.** AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (2026-08-29_draft, now superseded), for continuity:

- ★ **★ ADVERSARIAL CORRECTION — the abandoned Aug 28 draft's CME FedWatch September hike-odds figure was wrong.** Corrected from ~35.4%→~45.7% to the real ~35%→~56-58% (Motley Fool 57.5% citing CME FedWatch directly; CNBC "nearly 56%"; a third independent read at 55.7%) — past coin-flip, not just approaching it.
- ★ **★ CORRECTED — BTC's reaction to the speech.** Not a stable tape: BTC fell from above $81,000 pre-speech to $79,613.44 (Aug 28 close), continuing to $77,666.16 by Aug 29.
- ★ **★ NEW — jobless claims, week ended Aug 22 (DOL, primary, Aug 27): 203K vs. 208K consensus.** Mildly hawkish-adjacent, not independently trigger-worthy.
- ★ **★ NEW — Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 26 (federalreserve.gov, primary): reserves −$10,351M w/w to $2,924,936M; TGA −$2,876M w/w to $950,736M.** Routine continuation of the known pattern, not independently trigger-worthy.
- **Carried forward, re-confirmed, not re-litigated — Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Chair (Aug 28) and July PCE (bea.gov, Aug 26, 3.7% y/y headline, 0.1pp hot).** Both first surfaced in the abandoned Aug 28 draft; verbatim-confirmed and re-sourced this cycle.
- **Score re-rate: 43/41/48/56/62 → 36/35/45/55/61** — 1mo -7, 3mo -6, 6mo -3, 1yr -1, 3yr -1, deeper than the abandoned draft's -5/-4/-2/-1/-1 because the corrected market move is bigger.
- **Status decision:** left as a draft, NOT auto-stamped, and flagged for Alex's manual review — this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (every window here also moved ≤7 points, well under the ~8-point threshold, so it isn't even a close call).

Carried forward — the abandoned Aug 28 catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft) was written but never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, for continuity:

- **That draft re-rated P to 38/37/46/55/61** on the same Warsh speech and PCE print this cycle re-verifies, using a since-corrected CME odds figure (~45.7%, now corrected to ~56-58%) and a since-corrected "stable tape" BTC characterization (now corrected to a real, visible decline). It sits superseded; its underlying facts, corrected, are folded into this cycle above.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2), for continuity:

- **NEW — FOMC minutes' hawkish bloc wider than previously known:** beyond the three named dissenters, "several participants" also favored a hike and "many participants" saw tightening as possibly necessary if inflation didn't decline (federalreserve.gov, primary, Aug 19; corroborated by CNBC, Quartz, Newsquawk, goldsilver.com).
- **NEW — 30-year Treasury yield hit 5.31-5.33%, a ~19-year high,** around Aug 17-18, driven substantially by the CBO's raised $2.1T FY deficit projection and heavy long-bond supply, not purely Fed repricing (Bloomberg, CNBC, Axios).
- **NEW — equities sold off Aug 20** (S&P −0.87%, Dow −1.32% partly Walmart-driven, Nasdaq −1%) with a partial Aug 21 recovery, attributed to a mix of the hawkish minutes and rising yields.

- **NEW — CME FedWatch/Kalshi/Polymarket/investing.com/defirate.com independently re-pulled and cross-checked directly:** September-hold odds cluster ~68-70% across all five, essentially unchanged before and after the Aug 19 minutes — the hawkish content was already priced.
- **NEW — a circulating "93.6% September hike probability" claim was traced this cycle to a garbled conflation with Kalshi's July-meeting hold odds (~92-93% hold) and confirmed not credible for September — explicitly discarded, not used.**
- **Re-confirmed, not new — jobless claims week ended Aug 15: 206K vs. 210K consensus, 4-week average 204K** (DOL, primary, Aug 20) **— confirms the low-layoff trend already in the baseline.**
- **Re-confirmed, not new — July retail sales miss (-0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% consensus, still +5.0% y/y) — a genuine but noisy dovish-leaning counter-signal, per this pillar's discipline against chasing single prints, not sized into a move alone.**
- **Score decision:** **P held flat at 43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62 — the hawkish minutes detail and the noisy weak retail-sales print largely offset an already-priced rate-odds market; nets to a wash.**
- **New pending triggers logged for the next cycle:** **PCE (July data, bea.gov) due Aug 26; Chair Warsh's first speech as Chair at Jackson Hole, Aug 28, 10:00am ET, theme "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy" — the single highest-signal event on this pillar's near-term calendar.**
- **Status decision:** **this score set was left as a draft at delivery, not auto-stamped, because it is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from Alex's delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of how clean the underlying evidence is (no pillar's P moved more than 8 points, no master call band flipped — that clean-evidence bar qualifies daily cycles for self-approval, not weekly refreshes). COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026 after independent review.**

Sources

Retrieved & graded September 12, 2026, light daily catch-up — click and judge the quality yourself. Official data first, then reporting, then prices & flows, then rate odds (market-implied sentiment, not fact). This cycle: confirming Fed Chair Warsh's hawkish quote traces to Aug 28 Jackson Hole, not a fresh Sept 11-12 statement; no new primary data release found.

- **September 12, second cycle of the day (2026-09-12_draft2): sca.isr.umich.edu — University of Michigan Surveys of Consumers, preliminary September 2026 (PRIMARY, fetched directly and independently re-verified, released Fri Sept 11): sentiment 47.8, −7.5% m/m, −13.2% y/y; Current Conditions 50.9; Expectations 45.8; year-ahead inflation expectations 4.6% (from 4.0%), long-run 3.4% (from 3.3%); Director Joanne Hsu quoted on record · core-CPI consensus correction — CNBC ("CPI inflation report August 2026"), Benzinga, Yahoo Finance, Quartz, CBS News ("Fed rate hike in September is all but guaranteed after CPI report"), ts2.tech: all place pre-print core consensus at +0.2% m/m and describe the +0.3% actual as an overshoot; the print itself re-verified against bls.gov/news.release/cpi.nr0.htm (PRIMARY) · CBS News — EY-Parthenon changing its call from hold to a 25bp hike (target 3.75-4.00%, from the current 3.50-3.75%) and Capital Economics projecting December and March 2027 increases (INSTITUTIONAL ESTIMATES) · CME FedWatch via Quartz, Yahoo Finance, CBS News, IndexBox — Sept 16 hike probability ~90% Friday Sept 11, up from ~70% Thursday (a MARKET PRICE, press-reported off CME rather than pulled from the venue, explicitly not used to move P) · run.py quant, local full refresh — BTC $77,313.24 (Sept 12).**
- **September 12, first cycle of the day (committed 2026-09-12_draft): CNBC ("Forget Today's Inflation Report..." via Motley Fool, Sept 11), Fortune, WEIS Radio — confirming Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's "we have work to do" remarks date to the Aug 28, 2026 Jackson Hole speech (federalreserve.gov/newsevents/speech/warsh20260828a.htm), not a new Sept 11-12 statement · CNBC — market-implied September hike odds moved toward ~90% following the CPI print and Warsh's framing — a market price, not used to move P · no new BLS/Fed primary release found since the Sept 11 CPI print; the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remains the next dated catalyst · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC $77,289.66 (Sept 12) vs. $77,063.25 (Sept 11).**
- **September 11 light daily catch-up: bls.gov — Consumer Price Index Summary, August 2026 (primary, released 8:30am ET Sept 11): headline +0.4% m/m SA / +3.4% y/y NSA; core +0.3% m/m / +2.4% y/y; energy +2.1%, gasoline +3.9%, shelter +0.3%. Fetched directly and re-fetched to confirm · pre-print consensus (Kiplinger and other market previews): headline +0.4% m/m / 3.4% y/y, core +0.4% m/m / 2.4% y/y — a forecast, used only to characterise the surprise · market-implied September hike odds ~70% for 25bp [CORRECTED in the Sept 12 second cycle (2026-09-12_draft2): the real pre-print core consensus was +0.2% m/m, so the +0.3% print was a tenth HOTTER, not cooler — this up-move has been reversed. See This Cycle above.] around the print — a market price, explicitly not an institutional estimate and not used to move P · flagged: several aggregator summaries published within minutes of the release carried figures inconsistent with the BLS document (e.g. 3.1% core y/y) and were discarded.**
- **September 10 light daily catch-up: general web search for Fed speeches/H.4.1/CPI/PPI/jobless-claims releases dated Sept 9-10 — none found; the Aug CPI release (due Sept 11) and the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remain the next dated catalysts, unchanged since Sept 9.**
- **September 9 light daily catch-up: CNBC, cryptonews — CME FedWatch-citing coverage, September 25bp-hike odds ~58.7% as of Sept 7, consistent with the ~56-58% cluster already priced into the baseline · general web search for Fed speeches/H.4.1/CPI/PPI/jobless-claims releases dated Sept 8-9 — none found; no new FOMC meeting or BLS/DOL primary release since Sept 3-4. The Sept 11 CPI print and Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remain the next dated catalysts.**
- **September 8 light daily catch-up: general web search for Fed speeches/H.4.1/CPI/PPI/jobless-claims releases dated Sept 6-8 — none found. Governor Waller's Sept 3 speech and the Sept 4 BLS August jobs report remain the most recent inputs, both already reflected in the Sept 5 re-rate. The Sept 11 CPI print and Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remain the next dated catalysts.**
- **September 6 light daily catch-up: general web search for Fed speeches/H.4.1/CPI/PPI/jobless-claims releases dated Sept 5-6 — none found; September 6 is a Saturday, no data or speeches scheduled on the Fed's calendar. Governor Waller's Sept 3 speech and the Sept 4 BLS August jobs report remain the most recent inputs, both already reflected in the Sept 5 re-rate. The Sept 11 CPI print remains the next dated catalyst.**
- **September 5 light daily catch-up: BLS Employment Situation, August 2026 (primary, released Sept 4) via CNBC ("U.S. payrolls rose 162,000 in August, much more than expected; unemployment rate at 4.1%") and UPI — nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus, unemployment 4.1%, average hourly earnings +$0.10/+0.3% m/m/+3.1% y/y · CNBC, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, U.S. News, Investing.com/Reuters — market reaction and September FOMC hike-odds repricing (estimates ranging ~60-66% by source/timestamp), Fed officials split (Warsh hawkish, Waller conditionally dovish), Sept 11 CPI flagged as the likely decider · Yahoo/TheStreet — Sept 4 market close: 2yr yield +5.3bp to a high since Jan 2025, Dow −271.86 (−0.51%) to 53,414.25, S&P −0.38% to 7,718.60, Nasdaq −0.29% to 26,506.99 · data/btc_usd_daily.csv (GitHub Actions fetch) — BTC $81,265.00 (Sept 3) → $79,676.60 (Sept 4) → $79,646.11 (Sept 5).**
- **September 3 light daily catch-up (no new score set): general web search for H.4.1/CPI/PPI/jobless-claims releases dated Sept 2-3 — none found; CME FedWatch continuing the same drift already priced in.**
- **September 2 light daily catch-up: general web search for H.4.1/CPI/PPI/jobless-claims releases dated Sept 1-2 — none found · CME FedWatch — September 15-16 FOMC pricing reads roughly 60% hold, continuing the same post-Jackson-Hole drift already priced into the Sept 1 baseline · Bitstamp — BTC $76,581.44 (Sept 2) vs. $78,038.78 (Sept 1).**
- **September 1 light daily catch-up: Forbes, KuCoin — CME FedWatch September hike odds ~66% as of 11:40am ET Aug 31, continuing the same post-Jackson-Hole drift sequence already priced into the Aug 31 baseline · general web search for H.4.1/jobless-claims releases dated Aug 31-Sept 1 — none found (Aug 31 was Labor Day, a US federal holiday; next H.4.1 due Sept 3) · Bitstamp — BTC $78,038.78 (Sept 1) vs. $78,447.16 (Aug 31).**
- **August 31 light daily catch-up: CoinSpectator/Bitcoin.com — "Fedwatch Turns Hawkish With 57% Odds of September Rate Increase" (Aug 30) · CNBC — "Jackson Hole analyst roundup: Warsh's speech sends hike chances higher" (Aug 31) — CME FedWatch ~60.4%, up from ~56% Friday · general web search for H.4.1/jobless-claims releases dated Aug 29-31 — none found beyond the Aug 27 H.4.1 already priced in (next H.4.1 due Sept 3) · Bitstamp — BTC $78,447.16 (Aug 31) vs. $77,666.16 (Aug 29).**
- **August 29 check (full weekly refresh — adversarial verification): federalreserve.gov — Warsh Jackson Hole transcript (primary, re-fetched and verified verbatim this cycle): "And while this summer's PCE and CPI readings were better than expected, they do not tell me that underlying trends have meaningfully improved" — confirms the quote**

used in the abandoned draft; the "may need to raise rates" framing is confirmed as a media paraphrase (CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Forbes, Spectrum News), not present verbatim in the transcript · Motley Fool — CME FedWatch quoted directly at 57.5% hike odds post-speech · CNBC — body text "nearly 56%" post-speech (its "coin flip" headline rounds that down, not a contradiction) · a third independently-sourced read citing "55.7%... about 20 points higher than a day ago" — all three cluster tightly and CORRECT the abandoned draft's ~45.7% figure, which is treated as a stale/garbled snapshot and discarded · DOL/ETA — initial jobless claims release, week ended Aug 22 (primary, Aug 27): 203,000 vs. 208,000 consensus, prior week revised to 207,000; continuing claims 1.778M vs. 1.79M forecast · federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, week ended Aug 26 (primary): reserve balances $2,924,936M (−$10,351M w/w), TGA $950,736M (−$2,876M w/w) · Bitstamp — BTC open ~$80,262 and intraday high above $81,000 (Aug 28, pre-speech), close $79,613.44 (Aug 28, post-speech), close $77,666.16 (Aug 29, today) — corrects the abandoned draft's "stable tape" characterization.

- August 28 check (written for the abandoned, never-delivered Aug 28 catch-up draft; carried forward and corrected this cycle): federalreserve.gov — "Keynote remarks by Chairman Warsh at the 2026 Jackson Hole Economic Policy Symposium" (primary transcript, Aug 28), corroborated by Washington Post (this cycle's direct re-fetch was blocked 403; relied on search-summary), CNBC, PBS, CNN, and Yahoo Finance — cooler summer PCE/CPI prints "do not tell me that underlying trends have meaningfully improved," possible rate hikes signaled (media paraphrase, not verbatim), no forward-guidance commitment · Reuters/investing.com — market reaction: CME FedWatch September hike odds ~35.4%→~45.7% same-day — **CORRECTED this cycle to ~35%→~56-58%, see the August 29 check above** — 2yr yield to a ~1-month high (confirmed +6.6bp to 4.29%), 30yr yield -~1.5bp, stocks little changed · Yahoo Finance — July 2026 PCE inflation data, sourced to bea.gov (primary): headline +0.2% m/m/3.7% y/y (0.1pp hot vs. consensus), core +0.2% m/m/3.3% y/y (in line); consumer spending +0.2% m/m ($36.3B), personal income +0.4% m/m ($115.1B) · Bitstamp — BTC close $79,613.44 (Aug 28) vs. $77,266.84 (Aug 22, previously confirmed) — this price point is now superseded by the $77,666.16 Aug 29 close, see the August 29 check above.
- August 22 draft2 check (full weekly refresh, carried forward): federalreserve.gov — FOMC minutes, Jul 28-29 meeting (primary), corroborated by CNBC, Quartz, Newsquawk, and goldsilver.com — NEW detail this cycle: hawkish bloc wider than the three named dissenters ("several participants" favored a hike beyond them; "many participants" saw tightening as possibly necessary), PCE 4.1% (May actual)/3.4% core cited, June staff estimate 3.7%/3.3% core "remains elevated," unemployment steady 4.2%, wages 3.5% y/y moderating · Census.gov — Monthly Retail Trade Sales Report (primary): July retail sales −0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% consensus, steepest drop since May 2025, still +5.0% y/y, broad-based (autos, gasoline, electronics, nonstore) with Prime-Day calendar noise · Bloomberg, CNBC, and Axios — 30-year Treasury yield 5.31-5.33%, a ~19-year high (~Aug 17-18), tied to the CBO's raised $2.1T FY deficit projection (~$200B above its Feb estimate) and heavy long-bond supply · Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, and CNBC — Aug 20 equity reaction: S&P 500 −0.87% to 7,641.16, Dow −703.84 (−1.32%) to 52,759.21 (partly Walmart-earnings-driven), Nasdaq −1% to 26,067.17, partial Aug 21 recovery · CME FedWatch, Kalshi, Polymarket, investing.com, and defirate.com — independently re-pulled and cross-checked Sept-meeting rate odds, Aug 17-22: CME 68.4-69.4% hold, Kalshi 70.5% hold/28.5% hike, Polymarket ~68.5% hold, investing.com 64.7% hold, defirate.com blended 68.3% hold/30.6% hike — essentially unchanged before/after the Aug 19 minutes; a circulating "93.6% September hike probability" figure traced to a garbled conflation with Kalshi's July-meeting hold odds, confirmed not credible, discarded · DOL/ETA — jobless claims, week ended Aug 15: 206K vs. 210K consensus, 4-week average 204K (primary, re-confirmed) · bea.gov — PCE release schedule (primary): July PCE due Aug 26, not yet landed.
- August 22 draft1 check (catch-up cycle, delivered earlier the same day): DOL/ETA — initial jobless claims release, week ended Aug 15: 206,000 actual vs. 210,000 consensus; prior week (Aug 8) revised up to 212,000 from 209,000; continuing claims (week ended Aug 8) 1,799,000 vs. 1,790,000 forecast, up from 1,777,000 · federalreserve.gov — H.4.1 current release page: confirms the release still on file covers the week ended Aug 19 (published Aug 20), no new print since, next release Aug 27 · bls.gov — CPI release schedule: next release Sept 11 (August data), nothing new in this window · bls.gov — PPI release schedule: next release Sept 10, July PPI (Aug 13) already known before the Aug 16 baseline · federalreserve.gov — speeches & testimony page: no new Warsh remarks Aug 16-22; his first Jackson Hole speech as Chair is scheduled Aug 28 · CME FedWatch (futures-implied, not a prediction market): as of Aug 17, ~69.4% hold / ~30.6% hike for the September FOMC meeting, essentially flat vs. the Aug 16 baseline's ~65% post-minutes read · Kalshi and Polymarket — Sept FOMC markets, Aug 18 read: hold ~70.5¢, hike ~28.5¢, cut ~0.5-1¢, corroborating CME FedWatch across two independent venues · Bitstamp — BTC close $77,169.40 (Aug 22), vs. $71,882.92 (Aug 20 close, previously confirmed). **Not trusted at face value:** the Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts and the interrupted Aug 21 delivery session, none of which were rendered, verified, archived, or committed.
- August 19-20 check (carried forward, re-confirmed): federalreserve.gov — Minutes of the Federal Open Market Committee, July 28-29, 2026 (primary, published Aug 19, 2:00pm ET): confirms the 9-3 hold vote and the Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent; new detail — "many participants assessed that policy tightening would likely be necessary if inflation did not decline," inflation risks characterized as tilted to the upside, specific concern flagged on AI-related input costs (chips, steel, electricity); no explicit forward guidance from Chair Warsh; a balance-sheet task-force report to inform future deliberations, no near-term QT-pace signal · CNBC — FOMC minutes coverage (Aug 19) · Motley Fool — minutes coverage, hawkish-breadth read (Aug 19) · Newsquawk — FOMC minutes review; CME FedWatch September-hold odds ~65% post-minutes, up from a pre-minutes ~50/50 (Aug 19) · investinglive — minutes market reaction, corroborating the CME FedWatch move (Aug 19) · CME FedWatch tool (futures-implied probability, not a prediction market — labeled distinct from Polymarket/Kalshi) — September 16 hold ~65% as of the Aug 19 evening read · general search for jobless claims (week ended Aug 15) and H.4.1 (week ended Aug 19) dated Aug 20 — neither confirmed as published as of this research pass; logged PENDING, not assumed · Bitstamp — BTC close $71,882.92 (Aug 20), vs. $62,937.03 (Aug 16 close, previously confirmed).
- August 16 check: CNN — "Frustrated US consumers cut their retail spending last month" (Census Bureau primary, published Aug 14): headline −0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% expected, core −0.2%, first decline in nine months · census.gov — Monthly Retail Trade Sales Report (primary) · Federal Reserve — FOMC minutes release schedule confirms Jul 28-29 minutes due Aug 19; no new H.4.1 or claims print since Aug 13-14 (both due Aug 20).
- August 14 check: federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, week ended Aug 12, 2026 (primary, direct pull): reserve balances $2,944,059M (−$49,290M w/w), Treasury General Account $963,950M (+$56,626M w/w), cross-checked against the Aug 5 release (reserve balances $2,993,349M, TGA $907,324M) · DOL/ETA — jobless-claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 20 (week ending Aug 15); no new print since the 209K/week-ended-Aug-8 figure already incorporated Aug 13.
- August 13 check — the re-rate: BLS — Consumer Price Index, July 2026 (primary release): headline +0.1% m/m / +3.4% y/y, core +0.2% m/m / +2.5% y/y · CNBC — CPI inflation report, July 2026 (Aug 12) · NBC News — "Inflation remained stubborn" (Aug 12) · Bloomberg — CPI live-blog (Aug 12) · DOL/ETA — initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 8 (published Aug 13): 209,000 actual vs. 202,000 expected, +9,000 from the prior week's revised level, an 8-week high.
- August 11 light daily check: federalreserve.gov/releases/h41/ — release schedule confirms next H.4.1 due Aug 13 · dol.gov — weekly claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 13 · general web search for Fed/BLS/CPI news dated Aug 10-11 — no new release found; economic calendars (Kiplinger, FRED, BLS schedule) confirm CPI due Aug 12, PPI Aug 13.
- August 10 light daily check: DOL/ETA — initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 6, published Aug 8: 262,000 actual vs. 263,000 expected (in line with consensus) · federalreserve.gov/releases/h41/ — release schedule confirms next H.4.1 due Aug 13 · dol.gov — weekly claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 13 · general search for Fed/BLS news dated Aug 9-10 — no further new release found.
- August 9 light daily check: federalreserve.gov/releases/h41/ — release schedule confirms next H.4.1 due Aug 13 · dol.gov — weekly claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 13 · general search for Fed/BLS news dated Aug 8-9 — no new release found.
- August 8 full-weekly re-verification: CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger, CBS News, Forbes — convergent independent reporting of BLS Employment Situation, July 2026 (direct bls.gov fetch returned 403 this cycle) · federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, week ended Aug 5 (primary, direct pull): reserves +$8.78B w/w, TGA -$3.45B w/w · DOL-sourced coverage — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, 4-week average 198,750 · CBS News, Forbes-sourced pull — CME September-hold odds ~56% (2-source corroborated) · Kalshi — 65% hold (prediction market, labeled separately from CME) · Bank of America commentary (via multiple outlets, Aug 7-8) — sticking with 75bp-of-2026-hikes call · Morgan Stanley's Ellen Zentner (via reporting) — Aug 12 CPI named as the September decider · Richmond Fed President Barkin public remarks — "not loose, not tight."
- August 7 additions: federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, week ended Aug 5, 2026 (direct pull): total assets $6,748,567M, reserve balances $2,993,349M, cross-checked against the prior week's release (week ended Jul 29): total assets $6,738,190M, reserve balances $2,984,570M.
- August 6 additions: Fast Company, citing DOL — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, prior week revised to 198K.
- Jul 31-Aug 5 additions (prior week's catch-up): CNBC, Southeast AgNET — September cumulative hike odds ~81-82% (checked Aug 2, consistent with the Jul 30 baseline).
- July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh): federalreserve.gov — July 29 FOMC statement (primary): 9-3 hold, Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent · federalreserve.gov — press conference page · federalreserve.gov — last SEP (Jun 17, 2026; next Sept 15-16) · DOL/ETA — weekly claims release USDL 26-1273-NAT (primary, fetched directly): 197K week ended Jul 25, 188K revision for Jul 18 · CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes — FOMC outcome and dissent corroboration · Wolf Street — risk-off market reaction (single-source, flagged) · Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor — timestamped Jul 30 pull (62.4%), cross-checked against KuCoin (70.2%), Bloomingbit (73.5%→hike components), Southeast AgNet (81%) — none reconciling.
- July 13 check: federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, Table 1 & Table 5, re-verified directly line-by-line (no discrepancy vs. the July 9 release) · federalreserve.gov — H.4.1 release schedule (next: July 16) · dol.gov — weekly claims (unchanged since Jul 9; next Jul 16) · federalreserve.gov — July 2026 FOMC/testimony calendar · confirmed no new CPI,

PPI, FOMC, or H.4.1/claims release has landed since July 9–10; the next batch (CPI Jul 14, testimony Jul 14–15, PPI Jul 15, H.4.1/claims Jul 16) is still ahead.

- **Official data: Fed — June 16–17 FOMC minutes (released July 8) · Fed — H.4.1 balance sheet (rel. July 9: $6,735.6B; TGA $749.2B; reserves $3,098.9B; domestic RRP $2.75B; foreign-official RRP $346.1B) · DOL — weekly jobless claims (rel. July 9: 215K; continuing claims 1,814,000) · Fed — June 17 FOMC statement · BLS — Employment Situation, June 2026 (released July 2) · BEA — Personal Income & Outlays, May 2026 (core PCE 3.4%) · BLS — May 2026 CPI release (headline 4.2% y/y; core 2.9% y/y) · BLS — CPI release schedule (June CPI: July 14, 8:30am; July CPI: mid-August) · BLS — PPI release schedule (June PPI: July 15, 8:30am) · Fed — Waller's July 6 Rome speech.**
- **The reporting: Bloomberg — minutes: "a few" saw case for June hike · CNBC — June minutes coverage · Bloomberg — Warsh's five task forces (July 9; single source) · Bloomberg — claims 215K, layoffs low · Al Jazeera — Iran declares Hormuz "closed until further notice" (July 12) · Bloomberg — Brent +4% toward $79 on Hormuz re-escalation (July 13) · CNBC — CENTCOM strikes, Iran missile/drone attacks on five Gulf states (July 12) · offshore-technology.com — Kpler data: six vessels transited the Strait July 12 · CNBC — June jobs miss (+57K, −74K revisions) · Indeed Hiring Lab — participation 61.5% · CNBC — May PCE (core 3.4%, highest since Oct 2023) · CNBC — Warsh at Sintra (July 1) · Yahoo Finance — "This Committee will deliver price stability" · Bloomberg — Yardeni: "inflation, Fed back in play" (July 8) · Spokesman-Review (Bloomberg reprint) — Warsh testimony schedule (House Jul 14, Senate Jul 15) + June PPI forecast (~5.2% y/y core) · KuCoin flash — 30-year auction: $22B at 5.058%, stop-through, highest since 2007 · CoinDesk — the week-ahead calendar: CPI, PPI, Warsh testimony (July 13) · Federal Register — eSLR final rule (Dec 1, 2025; effective Apr 1, 2026). Flagged and discarded: CryptoTimes (July 13) and Blockhead (July 13) both wrongly report "core inflation at a three-year high of 4.2%" — this conflates headline CPI (4.2%, correct) with core CPI (actually 2.9% per BLS); not used.**
- **The prices & flows: Yahoo Finance — BTC ~$64.3K, ETH ~$1,796 (July 10 AM) · athens-times — BTC weekend pullback to ~$62.6–63K (single source) · Farside — BTC ETF flow table (authoritative; +$90.4M net, July 10) · CryptoRank — BTC ETF flow cross-check (July 10) · CoinDesk — BTC/ETH steady, gold slides (July 9) · KuCoin — June ETF outflows −$4.06B, worst month on record · CNBC — S&P 500 closes 7,575.39 (+0.42%), Dow +149.60 (July 10) · Trading Economics — 10Y ~4.58% · Trading Economics — DXY 101.13, +0.18% (July 13).**
- **The odds (market-implied, not fact): CME FedWatch — the tool itself (July 28–29 hold 78.5%, July 13 read; September ~66% combined, July 9 read) · FXEmpire — Sept +25bp 50.8% (July 9; single relay, directionally corroborated) · Yahoo Finance — September odds relay (July 9) · Polymarket — "Fed Decision in September" ladder: No change 56.5%, +25bp 38.5%, cuts (tail) 3.75%+2.1% (July 9) — diverges materially from CME's ~66% combined hike odds; reported as an open divergence, not resolved.**